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CONG REJECTS CLAIMS ITS MPs SUPPORTED UPI FEE PROPOSAL P5

'SAYING YES TO VVAAN WAS AN EASY DECISION' P12

TATA POWER STRUGGLE

Tata Sons reappoints Chandrasekaran, Noel-led Trusts calls vote 'legal nullity'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 17

Over a month after he said that he will step down as chairman of Tata Sons, the Board on Thursday backed N Chandrasekaran at the helm for another term of five years, the company said.

However, the decision has been contested by Noel Tara, Chairman of the Tata Trusts, which controls 66 per cent stake in the group.

The company's board met on Thursday for the first time since Chandrasekaran made his decision to quit public and said he agreed to the "Board's request to re-consider his decision".

"At the meeting of the Board on September 17, Chandra acceded to the Board's request to re-consider his decision. The Board thereafter resolved by a majority vote to re-appoint him as Executive Chairman for a further term of five years upon the expiry of his current tenure," Tata Sons said.

"In September 2025 the Board of Tata Sons agreed in principle to re-appoint Chandra as Executive Chairman for a further term of five years. Pursuant to applicable provisions of law, the Board decided to obtain the relevant formal approval in February 2026," Tata Sons said in a statement.

In February 2026, in the absence of unanimity, the resolution was deferred. In subsequent Board meetings in May and June, this matter was discussed but not resolved.

"In view of the above, on August 12, Chandra opted not to offer himself for re-appointment upon the expiry of his current term," Tata Sons said.

Current developments in Tata Sons have witnessed its most explosive boardroom crisis since the ouster of Cyrus Mistry nearly a decade ago.

The nearly three-hour meeting produced duelling statements, a disputed vote count, and a legal opinion from a former Chief Justice of India, leaving India's largest business house with two rival claims over who legitimately leads it.

Chandrasekaran, 63, had told the board last month he would not seek another term when his tenure ends on February 20, 2027, after the board repeatedly failed to reach unanimity on renewing his position.

That changed after the Reserve Bank of India rejected Tata Sons' bid to avoid a stock-market listing – a shift that led directors to lean on Chandrasekaran's continuity to reassure investors ahead of any listing process. Nevertheless, Trusts has asked Tata Sons to explore options other than listing on the stock market. While many of the Tata companies are listed on the share market, the holding company remains private. CONTINUED ON P4

KEY POINTS

- Core friction: Tata Sons board backs continuity; Tata Trusts wants a successor and opposes the move
- Trusts says Chandrasekaran's earlier decision to quit was already accepted and final
- Tata Sons maintains Chandrasekaran is reappointed, creating two competing claims over the chairmanship
- The dispute also reflects a deeper clash over Tata Sons' potential stock-market listing, opposed by the Trusts. Noel says listing is against the 'Tata model'

ECI FREEZES TMC SYMBOL, NAME

'Twin flowers' out of the ballot for bypolls

MPOST BUREAU
Kolkata, September 17

For the first time since Mamata Banerjee founded the Trinamool Congress in 1998 and the party entered the electoral fray, the familiar TMC name and 'twin flowers & grass' symbol will be missing from the ballot during the October 6 bypolls, with the Election Commission of India (ECI) on Thursday issuing an interim order freezing the use of the TMC name and its symbol by both rival factions amid their competing claims over the party's organisational control.

The two factions were earlier heard by the ECI over their rival claims to the party, name and symbol. The poll panel has now asked both sides to submit three alternative names and three symbols by 11 am on Friday (September 18), with the ECI expected to allot alternative names and symbols ahead of the October 6 bypolls.

The deadline assumes significance as both factions are contesting the Rejinagar and Nandigram bypolls, while the Mamata Banerjee-led faction is also contesting in Assam.

The EC is expected to finalise the alternatives by Friday evening to allow the two camps to begin their campaigns.

The development has also cast uncertainty over the TMC's traditional symbol ahead of the civic elections expected to be held by December this year, with the dispute potentially affecting the party's electoral identity among voters.

Reacting to the interim order, MP Kalyan Banerjee, who is with the Mamata Banerjee-led faction, said: "The order is illegal and we need time to decide over the matter."

Akhruzzaman, Chief Whip of the Ritabrata camp, said the faction would hold a meeting early on Friday before submitting its choices of names and symbols to the ECI.

Before the interim order, Kalyan Banerjee had expressed confidence that the Mamata faction would retain the symbol, arguing that the rebel CONTINUED ON P4

CLOSER LOOK

- The ECI has issued an interim order freezing use of the party name and symbol by both rival factions
- Both camps have been asked to submit three alternative names and symbols by 11am on September 18, with allotment expected by Friday evening
- The deadline comes ahead of the Rejinagar and Nandigram bypolls; the Mamata faction is also contesting in Assam
- 'Abdication of constitutional responsibility': Cong condemns EC

Briefs

Two labourers killed after car overruns them

GURUGRAM: Two labourers were killed and three people, including the driver of a speeding car, were injured after a Chevrolet Beat went out of control and hit workers near Shri Ram Chowk on the Dwarka Expressway early Thursday, police said.

The labourers were installing iron grilles to secure the CONTINUED ON P4

2 RS MPs special invitees to FCRA panel

NEW DELHI: In a rare move, Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla has nominated two Rajya Sabha MPs as "special invitees" to the joint parliamentary committee examining the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026. A Lok Sabha bulletin on Wednesday named Javed Ali Khan and James Pangsang Kongkal Sangma as the special invitees, ahead of the panel's first meeting on Friday. CONTINUED ON P4

SC asks CBSE to defer 3-language policy for Class 6

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday asked the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) to consider postponing the implementation of its three-language policy for Class 6 students until the 2027-28 academic session. A bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana made the suggestion during a hearing on a challenge to the policy. CONTINUED ON P4

India warns Washington's Russia sanctions Bill may hit bilateral relations

Says it is monitoring further developments

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, September 17

India on Thursday cautioned that US legislation allowing punitive tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries buying Russian crude could have consequences for bilateral ties with Washington as well as the global energy market.

The US House of Representatives on Wednesday passed the Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act 2026 by a vote of 262-159. The legislation, which was approved by the Senate last month, authorises President Donald Trump to impose sanctions on Russia and steep tariffs on major trading partners, including India and China. It will become law if signed by Trump.

Reacting to the development, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said India was closely monitoring further developments and would take all necessary steps to safeguard its trade and economic interests.

"As stated on several earlier occasions, India remains firmly committed to ensuring energy security for its 1.4 billion people," the MEA said.

India will continue to secure its energy needs through diversified sources and according to changing market conditions, it added.

Russia has emerged as a major source of India's energy supplies, with Indian purchases of Russian crude increasing substantially CONTINUED ON P4

CLOER LOOK

- US House passes Russia-Iran sanctions Bill
- Bill authorises tariffs of up to 100 per cent
- India and China among countries facing potential tariffs
- MEA vows measures to protect economic interests
- India remains committed to energy security
- Government cites energy needs of 1.4 billion people

PM MODI TURNS 76

BJP MARKS 25 YEARS IN PUBLIC LIFE

A sand artist creates a sand art to commemorate Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 76th birthday, at Pushkar, in Ajmer district, Rajasthan REPORT ON P5

Centre questions Meta's 'intermediary' status as child safety probe widens

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 17

The government has questioned whether Meta can continue to claim "intermediary" status and safe-harbour protection under Indian law, arguing that its paid advertising model and algorithms that influence what users see make it more than a neutral platform. A senior Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) official said on Wednesday that Meta, which owns Facebook and Instagram, may instead have to be treated as a service provider with greater responsibility for content on its platforms. The official said the final interpretation of the law and any decision on immunity would, however, rest with the judiciary.

Under Section 79 of the Information Technology Act, intermediaries can receive safe-harbour protection from liability for third-party content if they meet prescribed due-diligence requirements. CONTINUED ON P4

Centre to track daily if merchants pass UPI fee to consumers

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 17

The Centre will track UPI transactions and merchant pricing on a daily basis from October 15 to check whether sellers pass the newly introduced Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on to consumers, government officials said on Thursday.

The monitoring comes amid concerns among merchants and customers that the new fee on UPI payments above Rs 2,000 could result in higher prices or greater use of cash. "From October 15, we will monitor on a daily basis whether merchants are passing on the MDR to consumers. Comparisons will be made with last year," a government official said.

Officials said payment aggregators are working with the government to explain the new rules to merchants and clarify which transactions will attract the fee. The existing incentive scheme that subsidises eligible UPI payments of up to Rs 2,000, at a maximum of 0.15 per cent, will end after October 15.

The government expects the revised system to generate around Rs 15,000 crore annually, to be shared among banks, payment service providers and third-party apps. Industry estimates put the annual cost of operating UPI at around Rs 20,000 crore.

Officials also rejected claims that the MDR was introduced because of US pressure. They said the move was intended partly to create revenue opportunities for smaller payment players. "You can keep a system running through subsidies, but that can't ensure innovation," a senior official said. Of more than 24,000 crore UPI transactions in 2025-26, around 30 per cent were person-to-merchant payments, and only 4 per cent of those exceeded Rs 2,000.

- Government says it does not expect a significant rise in cash usage after OCTOBER 15
- Officials said the impact of the new MDR will become clear only after implementation

MODI PITCHES INDIA AS TRUSTED GLOBAL CHIPMAKING HUB

SEMICON India opens with Rs 1 lakh cr investment interest

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, Sep 17

SEMICON India 2026 opened on Thursday with Prime Minister Narendra Modi positioning India as a trusted destination for semiconductor manufacturing, as global companies announced fresh investments and partnerships across chipmaking, materials, packaging, research and talent development.

The three-day event, being held from September 17 to 19 under the theme "Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem", comes as the government steps up its semiconductor programme. Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said investment interest of about USD 11-12 billion, or nearly Rs 1 lakh crore, has emerged following the launch of Semicon 2.0.

Approved in July 2026 with an outlay of Rs 1,27,500 crore, the second phase CONTINUED ON P4

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurates SEMICON India 2026, at Yashobhoomi, in New Delhi. Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw and MoS Jitin Prasada are also present PTI

KEY POINTS

- Semicon 2.0 attracted USD 11-12 billion investment interest
- Investment interest equals nearly Rs 1 lakh crore
- Semicon 2.0 carries Rs 1,27,500 crore government outlay
- New phase could create nearly one lakh jobs
- Modi said Indian-made chips are reaching customers

SC expresses shock over deaths in relief camps

Asks Manipur chief secretary to respond

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 17

The Supreme Court on Thursday sought an affidavit from the Manipur chief secretary on deaths, particularly unnatural deaths, reported at relief camps housing internally displaced persons (IDPs), and directed authorities to take steps to investigate the cases and protect camp residents.

A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana questioned the state over the lack of significant action on information submitted by the Justice Gita Mittal committee about deaths in the camps. "We direct the chief secretary of Manipur to file an affidavit on deaths, especially unnatural deaths, at relief camps in Manipur," the bench said. It also sought an explanation for postmortems being conducted in only 20 of 34 reported death cases.

The court further asked why compensation of only Rs 20,000 to CONTINUED ON P4

Abhishek Sharma smashes India's fastest T20I century

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 17

Abhishek Sharma rewrote India's T20I record books on Thursday, smashing a century off just 30 balls during the third and final match against Afghanistan. The 26-year-old left-hander surpassed former India captain Rohit Sharma's record for the fastest T20I hundred by an Indian. Rohit had reached the milestone in 35 balls against Sri Lanka in December 2017. CONTINUED ON P4

'Enough is enough': HC warns DUSU results could be stayed

Court says democratic student polls must not turn violent

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi , September 17

The Delhi High Court on Thursday expressed strong displeasure over alleged incidents of violence and hooliganism during campaigning for the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections and warned that it would stay the counting of votes and declaration of results if authorities do not take satisfactory action for the "unruly conduct".

Voting is scheduled to be held on Friday and counting of votes on September 19. Campaigning ended on Wednesday.

The Division Bench of Chief Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia remarked, "Enough is enough," observing that a democratic process cannot be allowed to acquire the character of a "criminal society". The court said criminal behaviour cannot be justified in the name of democracy and directed Delhi Police and Delhi University to file status reports by Friday on action taken against alleged violators, warning that stricter orders could follow if the responses were inadequate.

"No excuses will be accepted by the court. We are making it very clear that though we are not staying the election or postponing the election, if we are not satisfied by your action, tomorrow we can pass harsher orders, including staying the counting and declaration of results," the bench stated.

"What we feel is that unless such drastic orders are passed, no one is going to come to terms and it is very sad. Please tell us if you are unable to control the situation. We know how to get it done. This can't be permitted," it further said. The court said the lawyers representing the various students organisations should appear for hearing Friday.

Advocate Prashant Manchanda said Wednesday was the "blackest day" in the history of DUSU elections, when certain persons hijacked DU's north campus area and professors and students were beaten.

Manchanda, whose petition concerning DUSU polls is pending in court, said he received messages from teachers and students saying that "guns have been used and the entire campus has been hijacked".

"The court may see the CCTV footage of LC-1 area. That shows that children were hounded and they were locked in their rooms by goons who came from outside," he contended.

Manchanda's latest application alleged that this year, election campaigning witnessed violence, vandalism, large-scale mobilisation and entry of outsiders and use of fleets of high-end vehicles, which included cars without registration plates, etc, in complete violation of the norms.

The court flagged a "complete failure" to ensure orderly DUSU elections, citing cars without number plates and alleged outsiders. It questioned DU and police over campus control. The Centre assured action against those responsible, while DU said steps would be taken.

Students affiliated with ABVP and Fraternity Movement engage in a scuffle during campaigning PTI

CLOSER LOOK

» **'No excuses will be accepted by the court. We are making it very clear that though we are not staying the election or postponing the election, if we are not satisfied by your action, tomorrow we can pass harsher orders, including staying the counting and declaration of results': Bench**

» **'What we feel is that unless such drastic orders are passed, no one is going to come to terms and it is very sad. Please tell us if you are unable to control the situation. We know how to get it done. This can't be permitted,' it further said. The court said the lawyers representing the various students organisations should appear for hearing Friday**

ABVP, NSUI and Left alliance prepare for DUSU showdown

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi , September 17

With polling for the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections scheduled for Friday, major student organisations, including the ABVP, NSUI and the AISA-SFI alliance, are set for a closely watched contest for the four central panel posts.

Polling for day classes will be held from 8.30 am to 1 pm, while students in evening classes can vote from 3 pm to 7.30 pm. Counting will begin at 8 am on September 19 at the Multipurpose Hall of the University Sports Stadium in North Campus, with entry through Gate No. 2.

The university has deployed 1,000 EVMs, of which 960 will be used for polling and 40 kept in reserve. Chief Election Officer Raj Kishore Sharma said 12 control rooms would remain functional, with technical experts available to address any glitches. After polling, the EVMs will be transported under police security to the counting venue.

The contest for president, vice-president, secretary and joint secretary is between candidates from the ABVP, Congress-backed NSUI and AISA-SFI alliance, among others. The final provisional list has seven candidates for president, five for vice-president, four for secretary and four for joint secretary.

The ABVP has fielded Yash Dabas for president, Ishu Maurya for vice-president, Riya Chhawadi for secretary and Lakshya Raj Singh for joint secretary. Dabas, a student of Buddhist Studies and an international-level tennis player, has competed in ITF events in Spain, Australia and Serbia. Maurya is a law student at Campus Law Centre, while Chhawadi studies BA Programme at Sri Aurobindo College. Singh, also from Campus Law Centre, has represented India in handball at the Asian Games and World Championship, according to the organisation. The NSUI candidates are Vijay Shankar Meena for president, Vir Chatrath for vice-president, Namrata Chaudhary for secretary and Gopal Choudhary for joint secretary. The organisation's campaign has focused on putting student interests first, with its 'My Campus, My Manifesto' initiative seeking suggestions from students.

The AISA-SFI alliance has nominated Ananya Raturi, Akshat Shikhar, Stanzin Deskyong and B Parijaat for president, vice-president, secretary and joint secretary, respectively. The alliance has campaigned on 'alternative politics', affordable accommodation and hostel facilities, and opposed what it calls 'money and muscle politics'. Student safety and accommodation have emerged as key issues following the Satya Niketan building collapse earlier this month, which killed seven people, including students. The ABVP has proposed a Student Housing Cell and safety audits.

The university has imposed traffic restrictions on Chhatra Marg, Probyn Road and University Road on Friday and Saturday until the results are declared. In the 2025 election, the ABVP won three central panel posts, including president, while the NSUI secured vice-president.

Domestic help, vegetable vendor nabbed over Rs 3-cr burglary

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi , September 17

Delhi Police have arrested a domestic help and a vegetable vendor and apprehended a juvenile in connection with the burglary of gold and diamond jewellery and cash worth around Rs 3 crore from an apartment in north Delhi's Timarpur.

The burglary was reported on September 6 from an apartment on Mall Road after the complainant's elder brother and his family, who had gone abroad on September 2, returned to find the locks of the first-floor portion and almirahs broken.

Police identified the accused as Anil Kamat, 22, a domestic help, and his father-in-law Dev Chandra Sah, 49, a vegetable vendor. A 17-year-old house servant from Giridih, Jharkhand, was also apprehended.

Police said 117 jewellery items and Rs 4.34 lakh in cash were recovered, resulting in complete recovery of the stolen property.

Teams examined over 300 CCTV cameras and tracked the suspects to Darbhanga and Giridih.

Sah was arrested after cash was recovered under hay sacks and jewellery buried underground in Supaul. Kamat was arrested from Pratapganj.

Police said they planned to open a café in Nepal.

Briefs

Two nabbed in fake share market fraud

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police's Cyber Cell has arrested Lalit Kumar, 21, and Parteek Kumar, 21, both from Bahadurgarh, Haryana, for allegedly duping victims through a fake online share market investment platform.

A Shahdara resident was allegedly lured through a WhatsApp advertisement and lost Rs 1.16 lakh after investing through five transactions. Police traced Rs 70,165 to Lalit's Airtel Payments Bank account and Rs 85,000 transferred to Parteek's SBI account. An iPhone 15 belonging to Parteek was seized for digital examination.

Six held in honey-trap kidnapping

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police arrested six people, including a couple, in a honey-trap-cum-kidnapping and extortion case and rescued a man from Mathura within a day. The victim was allegedly lured by Indu alias Riyu alias Lisa Sharma, 20, before being assaulted and confined by her husband Jitender Yadav, 32, and associates. Police said Rs 70 lakh was demanded from his family. The accused allegedly moved him through Haryana and UP in his SUV.

Min opens 'Bharat Vann' urban forest

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi , September 17

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Thursday inaugurated a Miyawaki-based urban forest at Lodhi Colony Park, with around 10,000 native saplings planted across 3,000 square metres.

The project, named 'Bharat Vann', has been developed by India Infrastructure Finance Company Limited (IIFCL) under its corporate social responsibility initiative and is being implemented by the Enviro Creators Foundation. The plantation uses the Miyawaki method, which creates a dense, multi-layered forest using native species. The project includes 36 months of maintenance to support the growth and survival of the saplings.

The inauguration was attended by senior IIFCL and NDMC officials. The event also included an interaction with students on environmental awareness and sustainable development.

Teenager raped, stabbed to death; 3 juveniles among 4 apprehended

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi , September 17

A 17-year-old girl was allegedly raped and stabbed to death before her body was dumped in an open field by four people, including three juveniles, police said on Thursday. The accused and the girl were known to each other.

The girl's decomposed body was found near Jaipal Rana's field on Kushak Road on September 13. Police said some parts had been eaten by stray dogs and one hand was found separated from the body. Its gender could not initially be ascertained.

Police said the girl had not been reported missing.

After registering a case under the BNS and POCSO Act, police analysed more than 50 CCTV cameras. Investigators tracked a tempo seen near the spot despite its registration number being unclear.

A night-long search led police to Khadda Colony, where the driver was traced. The driver was identified and questioned by police.

The four accused, including three juveniles aged 16 and 17, were apprehended. Two knives, clothes and the tempo were recovered. Further investigation is underway.

> **THE GIRL'S DECOMPOSED BODY WAS FOUND NEAR JAIPAL RANA'S FIELD ON KUSHAK ROAD ON SEP 13**

AIIMS, BPL join hands on AI Mammography Model

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi , September 17

The All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) has transferred an AI-based mammography interpretation model developed at the institute to BPL Technologies Limited for further development, validation and potential implementation.

The technology was transferred at AIIMS New Delhi on September 16 in the presence of AIIMS Director Prof Nikhil Tandon and BPL Technologies CFO Ajay Jindal. The model is designed to support the interpretation of mammography examinations and assist radiologists, particularly in areas with limited access to breast imaging specialists.

The transfer is part of an industry-academia collaboration between AIIMS and BPL Technologies. Tandon said research generated in academic institutions should be taken towards solutions addressing healthcare needs and expressed hope that the initiative would lead to further developments from AIIMS. Senior AIIMS and BPL Technologies officials attended the event, including Prof Govind Makharia, Prof Velpandian, Prof Smriti Hari and Dr Krithika Rangarajan.

DEATHS IN PG COLLAPSE REMAIN FRESH IN PUBLIC MEMORY

Students question timing of Seva Sankalp

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi , September 17

The Delhi government's month-long Seva Sankalp celebrations to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday have come under scrutiny from students and residents, with the Satya Niketan PG collapse and the deaths of seven people still fresh in public memory.

The government held several programmes on Thursday as part of the campaign, including blood donation drives, organ donation pledges and other public-service activities. However, for many students, the timing of large-scale celebrations has raised questions about the government's priorities barely days after the September 6 collapse of a five-storey PG building in Satya Niketan.

"After losing the lives of so many students in the Satya Niketan incident, why did the government not show solidarity with the children who lost their lives? When questions are still being raised about the lack of government action and safety checks, such a big celebration should not have been held at such a crucial time," a BA student from Delhi University said.

Another student said the immediate focus should have been on assuring those living in PGs across Delhi that their safety was being taken seriously.

A resident from Satya Niketan questioned the larger purpose of the campaign. "Is it really the job of a capital's government to celebrate birthdays on such a large scale instead of focusing on the people and their problems? If so many projects from different departments can be announced, inaugurated and rolled out within just one month, why were these things not done earlier? Why did the government have to wait for the Prime Minister's birthday to push them?" the resident said.

He said the issue was not about opposing public-service programmes, but about the government's response at a time when questions over student accommodation and safety remain unresolved.

"Celebrations can take place, but the families who have lost their children cannot celebrate. At this point, the government should have shown greater sensitivity towards the victims and their families," the resident said.

Students said the tragedy had exposed a problem extending beyond one building. "For years, students have depended on private PGs because affordable hostel accommodation is limited. The government should treat safe student housing as basic infrastructure, not something to be addressed only after a tragedy," another student said.

Opposition parties questioned the timing of the government's Seva Sankalp programmes after the Satya Niketan deaths. Meanwhile, an MCD survey found only 31 of 2,453 PG properties had fire NOCs, while eight had structural stability certificates, highlighting safety concerns.

Retd Tihar pharmacist cheated of Rs 1.75 crore

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi , September 17

The Delhi Police has arrested a criminal wanted in a Rs 1.75 crore cheating and forgery case in which a retired Tihar Jail pharmacist was allegedly duped through the sale of six plots using fake documents, officials said on Thursday.

The accused, Vinod Kumar Bhardwaj - alias Rahul, alias Pappu - was carrying a reward of Rs 50,000 and had been declared a proclaimed offender by a Tis Hazari court, they said.

The case was registered at Ranhola police station on the complaint of Kailash Narayan, who retired as a senior pharmacist from Tihar Jail in 2024.

According to police, the accused knew about Narayan through a property dealer, Parveen, and, along with his wife, brother-in-law B S Bhardwaj, and other associates, allegedly lured the pharmacist into investing his retirement savings in property.

The accused allegedly convinced the retired pharmacist to purchase six plots and sold them to him on the basis of fake and fabricated documents, causing him a financial loss of around Rs 1.75 crore, police said.

Police arrested Vinod from a residential society in Dwarka's Sector 5 after developing intelligence through field sources and technical surveillance. A proclaimed offender, he had a Rs 50,000 reward.

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BLOOD DONATION STRENGTHENS BOND OF HUMANITY: CM REKHA GUPTA

Delhi marks PM Modi's birthday with service initiatives

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 17

The Delhi government on Thursday marked Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday through a series of public service and welfare initiatives under the month-long 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan', including a mega blood donation camp, an organ donation pledge campaign, the launch of a workers' facilitation centre and a gig workers' rest area, besides a 108-Kundiya Yajna and special musical tributes by school and college students.

2,080 blood units collected

A mega blood donation camp was organised at Thyagaraj Stadium, where Chief Minister Rekha Gupta herself donated blood and appealed to Delhi residents to participate in the campaign. A total of 2,080 units of blood were collected at the camp. Union Minister of State Harsh Malhotra, Delhi Cabinet ministers, MLAs and other dignitaries were present at the event. Gupta said the 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan', being observed from September 17 to October 17 on the occasion of Modi's birthday, was inspired by his 25 years of public life and aimed at strengthening the spirit of service and public participation. "Blood donation is not merely the act of giving blood, but a noble pledge that strengthens the sacred bond of humanity, compassion and empathy," she said, urging those who could not donate blood on Thursday to voluntarily donate when eligible. Malhotra said, "Blood donation is 'Mahadaan' and there can be no greater act of service than saving the life of someone in need."

CM Rekha Gupta donates blood during a donation camp, in New Delhi, on Thursday

Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said blood donation and programmes related to health and public welfare would continue during the Seva Pakhwada.

Organ donation campaign launched

The government also launched an online organ donation pledge campaign, with Gupta herself taking the pledge and becoming the first person to register on the SOTTO website. The portal allows Delhi residents to pledge their organs online and automatically obtain a digital pledge certificate. "Organ donation reflects the true spirit of Seva Sankalp. One person's generous and noble pledge can save several lives," Gupta said, appealing to citizens to participate in the campaign. The government also made the State Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation (SOTTO) operational at G.B. Pant Hospital. It said the move would strengthen coordination and promotion of organ and tissue donation and transplantation activities in Delhi. Health Minister Singh said the dedicated pledge portal would make the process more accessible and encourage wider participation.

13 Shramik Seva Kendras planned

At Shalimar Bagh, Gupta inaugurated a 'Namo Shramik Seva Kendra' and a Gig Workers' Rest Area on Vishwakarma Day. The centre will provide workers assistance with registration and renewal, document verification, application status, welfare schemes and claims under one roof.

"Workers have built Delhi with their own hands, it is now the government's responsibility to ensure their convenience," Gupta said. Labour Minister Kapil Mishra said 13 Shramik Seva Kendras would be launched in the first phase and subsequently expanded across Delhi. Workers would also receive technical and foreign-language training aimed at opening employment opportunities abroad. The government said health vehicles would visit workplaces for regular check-ups and arrangements would be made for treatment if health problems are detected.

Yajna mark PM's birthday

Gupta also participated in a 108-Kundiya Yajna at Shri Khatu Shyam Delhi Dham in Alipur, where she prayed for Modi's good health, longevity and continued service to the nation.

Minister leads PM's b'day celebrations

Education Minister Ashish Sood joins students and teachers in lighting 'Aashirwad Ka Diya' during the 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan' at CM Shri School, Sarojini Nagar

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 17

Delhi minister Ashish Sood on Thursday led a series of public service and community initiatives in the city to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday and 25 years of public leadership.

Sood participated in a mega blood donation camp at Thyagraj Stadium, describing blood donation as "a vital act of service" and urging people to donate blood and "strengthen the spirit of service". At the Delhi Secretariat, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Sood launched two campaign songs for the 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan' in the presence of 250 school students. One song was prepared and sung by Delhi government school students, while the other was composed by a group of Delhi youth involved in music training.

In the evening, Sood joined students and teachers at CM Shri School, Sarojini Nagar, where participants created and lit symbolic earthen lamps as part of the 'Aashirwad Ka Diya' ceremony, offering prayers for Modi's health and continued leadership.

Sood also inspected civic works at Pankha Road in his Janakpuri constituency and lit the symbolic lamp with local residents. The area, which had earlier faced waterlogging, dirty water and silt accumulation, has undergone drainage desilting, boundary wall construction and development of a park with walking tracks.

"Transforming long-standing civic problems into clean, usable public spaces for our residents is the best way to honour Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi's vision of Seva and Swachhata," Sood said.

'Aashirwad Ka Diya': 1.25L diyas lit at Vijay Chowk

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 17

Around 1.25 lakh earthen lamps were lit from Kartavya Path to Seva Teerth at Vijay Chowk on Thursday as part of the 'Aashirwad Ka Diya' programme organised by the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 76th birthday.

The programme was held as part of 'Seva Diwas' and saw the participation of beneficiaries of Central government schemes, NDMC employees, students and teachers. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Union minister of state and Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra, New Delhi MP Bansuri Swaraj, NDMC chairman Manoj Kumar Dwivedi and vice-chairman Kuljeet Singh Chahal were among those present.

Gupta said the lamps represented citizens' wishes for the Prime Minister's long life and good health. "The manner in which Delhiites lit 'Ek Diya Aashirwad Ka' away from their homes today at Kartavya Path, outside Seva Teerth, is a beautiful expression of the affection, respect and trust that the people have for the Prime Minister," she said.

Malhotra said the occasion was significant as Modi had completed 25 years in public life. He said the diyas symbolised the "affection, respect and gratitude" of citizens and conveyed their wishes for his continued health and energy.

Swaraj said the Prime Minister had completed 25 years of continuous public service and noted that citizens had gathered at Vijay Chowk to pray for his health and long life. She also referred to projects around the area, including the new Parliament building, Seva Teerth and Kartavya Bhavans, saying these were steps towards the government's vision of a 'Viksit Bharat'.

Dwivedi said the lighting of 1.25 lakh diyas reflected "service, dedication and the spirit of nation-building". He said the collective participation of NDMC officers, employees and other participants was intended to reinforce their commitment towards public welfare.

Chahal said the programme provided beneficiaries of government schemes an opportunity to express their experiences and gratitude. "Diya of Blessings is not merely a programme of lighting lamps, but a medium to express the feelings of those who have benefitted from various government schemes and facilities," he said. Separately, the Delhi government organised the launch of two special songs at the Delhi Secretariat under the 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan'.

PINK TICKET facility extended till Sept 30

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 17

The Delhi government has extended the pink ticket facility for women passengers in Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) buses till September 30.

The transport department had earlier directed that the 'Pink Saheli' smart card would be mandatory from September 18.

"The competent authority has now been pleased to accord approval for further extension of the existing arrangement for issuance of paper-based pink tickets up to September 30. Accordingly, during this extended period, eligible women passengers may continue to be issued paper-based pink tickets for availing the free bus travel facility in DTC and cluster buses," an official order issued on Thursday said. During the extended period, eligible women passengers can continue to obtain paper-based pink tickets to avail the free travel facility in DTC and cluster buses. The government will focus on creating awareness about the smart card through depot and in-bus announcements, social media, print media and other channels, the order said.

"From October 1 onwards, free travel shall be permissible only upon tapping a valid Pink Saheli Smart Card," it said.

Briefs

Baansera set for tourism fest

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) will organise a two-day World Tourism Day celebration at Baansera, its bamboo themed public space along the Yamuna at Sarai Kale Khan, on September 26 and 27, with food, crafts, music, cultural performances and activities for visitors.

MCD launches Swachhata drive

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Thursday launched the month-long Swachhata Hi Seva (SHS) 2026 campaign across all 12 zones, with a focus on sanitation, solid waste management, SafaiMitra welfare and greater citizen participation.

DELHI SPECIAL INTENSIVE REVISION

Top Court to hear plea against deletion of names on Sept 21

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 17

The Supreme Court on Thursday agreed to hear on September 21 a plea against deletion of names from the electoral rolls under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise in Delhi.

A bench of Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said it will hear the matter on Monday as other matters related to the SIR are also listed next week.

Advocate Prashant Bhushan, appearing in the court for petitioners Anjali Bhardwaj and Amrita Johri, submitted that the Election Commission (EC) has issued notices to 33 lakh of the 47 lakh people whose names have been deleted from the electoral rolls during the SIR exercise in the national capital.

The petitioners have also sought a disclosure of the

criteria, definitions, algorithmic parameters and operational guidelines governing the classification of voters under the "Logical Discrepancies" category.

"What they have done is that they have not disclosed the names of the people who have been issued notices or on what grounds they have been deleted. They have not disclosed which people the notices have been issued to, what are the logical discrepancies and how are they unmapped," Bhushan submitted.

The plea filed under Article 32 of the Constitution has alleged violations of the fundamental rights guaranteed under Articles 14, 19 and 21, besides the constitutional rights under Articles 325 and 326.

The petitioners have sought directions for the publication of a consolidated, searchable list of all the voters against whom notices have been issued during the SIR process in Delhi, along with their addresses and the specific reasons or categories for each notice.

The plea further seeks directions requiring authorities to specify the precise discrepancy and material facts forming the basis of each notice, so that the voters can effectively participate in the hearing process.

It has also sought to restrain the deletion of names from the electoral rolls following proceedings based on vague notices that do not disclose the relevant factual particulars.

No Eligible Voter to be excluded and No Ineligible Person to be included
SIR 2026 DELHI
Special Intensive Revision, Delhi
Fill Appropriate Form:
FORM-6
Application for inclusion of Name in Electoral Roll for new voter
Eligible voters whose name does not reflect in the electoral roll. Please fill Form-6
Form-7
Objection for Proposed Inclusion/Deletion of Name in Existing Electoral Roll
Form-8
For Correction to particulars entered in Electoral Roll
To check your name in the electoral roll, visit: voters.eci.gov.in or www.ceodelhi.gov.in
Fill out and submit the form.
1. At the ERO/AERO office
2. With the BLO
3. At designated locations
To fill out the above form online, visit the voter's service Portal
voters.eci.gov.in
or
Use the ECINet Mobile App
Schedule

Revision Activities	Revise Schedule
Period for filling claim & objections	31.08.2026 to 30.09.2026
Notice Phase/Disposal of claims & objections	31.08.2026 to 29.10.2026
Final publication	04.11.2026

Special Camp
Will be organized at all polling station locations in Delhi on the following dates
BLO will be available to assist you.
20th September 2026 Sunday
27th September 2026 Sunday
Timings: 10:00 AM to 5:00 PM
You can avail yourself of the following services at these special camps
Check your name in the voter list
Form-6, 7, and 8 available at Polling Stations- Avail the service and update your Electoral Details
Get a solution for any issue related to the voter list
Note: Fill out Forms 6, 7, and 8 by 30-09-26 to ensure the electoral roll is accurate and up-to-date.
Download and get information
ECINet app
voters.eci.gov.in
Watch the video and read the FAQs for information
Chief Electoral Officer, Delhi
Old St. Stephen's College Building, Kashmere Gate, Delhi – 110006
Websites: www.ceodelhi.gov.in, voters.eci.gov.in
Voter Helpline No. 1950
Follow:
/ceodelhioffice
DIP/Shabdarth/Display/090/26-27

BEYOND TEJAS

India's aerospace push shifts from platforms to ecosystem

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, September 17

The transfer of LCA Tejas FOC twin-seat trainers and HTT-40 basic trainer planes to the IAF and Dhruv Next Generation helicopters to Pawan Hans Limited in Bengaluru on Friday is expected to serve as an indication of the larger shift in India's aerospace dreams from the development of indigenous platforms to establishing an ecosystem for their training, manufacture, and maintenance.

The presence of Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Civil Aviation Minister K Rammohan Naidu at the ceremony becomes even more significant when the three types of platforms signify different but interrelated components of India's aviation industry. In this case, while Tejas and HTT-40 contribute to the development of the military aviation ecosystem, Dhruv NG expands India's indigenous aerospace capabilities into the civilian sphere.

The strategic importance of the transfer can be seen especially in the development of an indigenous training-to-fighting pipeline system. The HTT-40 is the basic phase of military pilot training, whereas the Tejas twin-seater offers the pilots a platform for conversion and advanced training before they join the fighter role. The entire chain from the basic flight training to the fighter conversion to the operation phase might help in reducing the reliance on foreign platforms at various levels of the pilot training process.

This becomes increasingly necessary in view of the expansion of the induction of the indigenous Tejas fighter aircraft. The need for the programme is not only limited to the production of combat aircraft but also includes trainer aircraft, instructors, simulators, maintenance facilities, spare parts, and trained personnel. Thus, the induction of the twin-seater is a very crucial aspect of the Tejas ecosystem.

HAL and its industry associates have to deal with a more important issue, that of scaling up the manufacturing process. The nation may well have shown increasing capability in designing and manufacturing its own aircraft. However, maintaining such a sizable fleet depends on efficient supply chains, higher levels of manufacturing capability, ready availability of critical componentry and engines, maintenance facilities and an efficient supply chain of domestic providers. In other words, the future of indigenous military aviation capability will not depend solely on the design of such platforms, but on its manufacturing and sustainment capability, which is in turn driven by the demands of the military.

Centre confident of cleaning Yamuna before '29 deadline

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, September 17

FILE PHOTO

The Centre is confident of meeting its target of cleaning the Yamuna before the 2029 deadline, Union Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil asserted on Wednesday while replying a query from ***Millennium Post*** correspondent on government's proposal for cleaning the river.

Responding to a question on the government's proposal to clean the Yamuna, Patil said the nearly 50 km stretch of the river in Delhi was the most polluted one as "both the availability of water and the water coming out of hundreds of drains mixing with the river's water were issues."

"There is hardly any clean water in the river Yamuna in Delhi," he said, adding that he was confident that the government would meet its target of having a clean Yamuna before 2029. His comments came a day after Union Home Minister Amit Shah laid foundation to Kishau Multipurpose Project with an aim to improve water availability in the river and declared 2029 as the target year for cleaning the river.

The Kishau Project which is proposed to be constructed on Tons river, a tributary of River Yamuna, would provide around 25 per cent more water to Delhi and to the Yamuna itself, said Amit Shah while addressing the gathering on the occasion.

The project includes construction of a 232.6 metre high dam with a live storage capacity of 1,562 million cubic metres. Besides irrigation and power generation, the additional water so made available is expected to help in flushing the river Yamuna.

From page 1

Tata Sons

Noel Tata argued that under the guidance of the late Ratan Tata, the board had in March 2024 unanimously resolved to keep the holding company unlisted.

He stated that the Tata Group was conceived as a national service carried on through business for over a century. If listed, he claimed, it will destroy the Tata Sons' character.

"That is not sentiment. It is the operating model of this House, and it has stood the test of time for more than a century. A listing will destroy its character and strike at the heart of this principle," Noel Tata noted.

Tata Trusts rejected the outcome outright, branding the resolution a "legal nullity". The Trusts said Chandrasekaran's original decision to step aside "has been duly accepted and has attained finality" and that they had already directed Tata Sons to set up a selection committee for a successor.

Citing the company's Articles of Association, the Trusts argued that chairmanship resolutions require both Trust-nominated directors to vote in favour and since Noel Tata dissented, the vote "was rendered legally void and without any basis."

The Trusts disclosed that Noel Tata had submitted a legal opinion from former Chief Justice of India DY Chandrachud backing their position, which "was not taken note of by the Board". In a pointed statement to directors, Noel Tata argued the reappointment vote asked the board "to set aside three things at once: the Chairman's own stated decision, the acceptance of that decision by the majority shareholder, and the further process which that shareholder has asked this company to set in motion."

The clash revives memories of Tata Sons' last great boardroom war – the 2016 ouster of Cyrus Mistry as chairman, orchestrated by Ratan Tata and the Tata Trusts, which triggered years of litigation ending only when the Supreme Court upheld the Trusts' authority in 2021. Neither side indicated any legal filing had been made as of Thursday, but with Tata Sons treating Chandrasekaran as reappointed and the Trusts treating the vote as void, the dispute looks set for a reckoning – potentially at the company's annual general meeting, which must ratify the appointment, or in court. An eventual Tata Sons listing could rank among India's largest IPOs, with the conglomerate's valuation estimated near USD 230 billion.

'Twin flowers'

camp had failed to establish a valid organisational claim.

He had rejected the assertion that the TMC ceased to exist in 2025, saying the party constitution provides for organisational elections every five years, with the next scheduled for January 31, 2027.

Banerjee had also cited the 2026 Assembly elections, when both camps contested under the TMC symbol, and the party's recognition as an Assembly bloc as evidence of its continued existence.

He alleged that the rival faction's organisational exercise had not followed the required grassroots-to-block process and lacked proper notice.

The Mamata faction had also opposed parallel proceedings in a civil court and before the EC, seeking a final decision from the poll panel on the party's name and symbol.

Ritabrata's faction submitted documents sought by the ECI and also expressed confidence that its claim would succeed.

With the interim order now freezing the original name and symbol, both factions are expected to consider their next legal course, including the possibility of approaching the Supreme Court after the ECI's final decision.

Meanwhile, Congress condemned the ECI's decision, alleging that it was abdication of constitutional responsibility by the poll body.

Reacting to the development, Congress general secretary K C Venugopal alleged that freezing the TMC name and symbol was CEC Gyanesh Kumar's "late night birthday gift to Modi ji" after a "blatantly unconstitutional hijack by the BJP".

He alleged that TMC leaders who fought the BJP under Mamata Banerjee were now being encouraged to rebel against her and defect with the ECI's help. Calling the ECI a "puppet in the hands of the BJP", Venugopal said similar action had been taken in the cases of Shiv Sena and NCP.

"We condemn this move, and demand that the ECI immediately restore the two-leaf symbol to Mamata Banerjee ji," he said.

Congress media department head Pawan Khera said freezing the symbol was not "justice" but an "abdication of its constitutional responsibility". He said the breakaway TMC faction had "no legitimate claim" to the symbol, which, he argued, belongs to the party bearing the TMC name.

India warns

over the past few years. The proposed US legislation could therefore have wider implications for India's energy procurement.

The MEA said the issue had been discussed "at high levels in recent months" with several US interlocutors. India had clearly conveyed its concerns about the possible impact of the legislation on both the bilateral relationship and international energy markets, it said.

New Delhi has also told Washington that it remains prepared to take measures needed to protect its economic and trade interests. "The government will work closely with Indian trade and industry bodies to deal with the implications of these developments," the ministry said.

The legislation proposes sanctions against Russia's leadership and energy sector, besides targeting the so-called "shadow fleet" of vessels used to facilitate Russian oil shipments and circumvent sanctions.

It also gives Trump the authority to impose tariffs on China, India and other countries in an effort to reduce their reliance on Russian oil and gas. The Bill includes additional sanctions targeting Iran.

Ajay Srivastava of the Global Trade Research Initiative said the legislation could put significant pressure on India. He said Washington may exert greater pressure on New Delhi despite China purchasing more Russian crude, citing concerns over possible Chinese retaliation.

"The new US Act turns sanctions into a trade weapon against India," Srivastava said.

He also said the US could link tariff concessions in ongoing trade negotiations with India to reductions in Russian oil purchases and other concessions. Srivastava said India should protect its energy security rather than exchange it for temporary tariff relief.

Centre questions

The official said platforms that fail to comply with those obligations could lose that protection. "When you charge to show something on your platform, you are no longer neutral," the official said, referring to Meta's advertising business and content-selection algorithms.

Government sources separately told PTI that Meta can no longer be viewed as a "simple intermediary" when its algorithms determine content visibility. "Service providers have many responsibilities," the sources said, adding that Meta would have to assume further obligations if it accepts responsibility for content on its platforms. They said the government believes Meta does not have immunity in the present circumstances, while acknowledging that courts will have the final say.

The issue has gained urgency amid scrutiny over child sexual abuse material (CSAM), including allegations arising from a BBC Eye investigation. The report found that Instagram in India displayed advertisements using phrases such as "rape video" and "child video", which allegedly directed users to Telegram channels selling CSAM.

In July, MeitY issued Meta a notice over Child Sexual Exploitative and Abuse Material (CSEAM) in paid Instagram advertisements. The ministry ordered Instagram to disable advertisements and content promoting or facilitating access to such material and sought a detailed explanation. Several discussions with Meta executives followed, with the ministry maintaining that such content violates Indian law and cannot be protected by safe harbour.

Meta has now agreed to report child safety matters directly to the cybercrime portal operated by the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C). Previously, such cases were reported to the US-based National Center for Missing and Exploited Children. A Meta spokesperson said the company was committed to working with the government to hold perpetrators accountable.

The development came as Meta India Managing Director Arun Srinivas appeared before the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) on Wednesday. The 70-minute hearing, led by NCPCR chairperson Valeti Premchand, also involved senior MeitY and I4C officials.

Srinivas was questioned about Meta's safe-harbour eligibility, its earlier reporting practices, and its AI-based detection and labelling systems. According to people present, Meta sought more time to answer some questions. NCPCR has given the company two weeks to submit a report.

The commission had issued its initial notice on July 3 after taking suo motu cognisance of the BBC report. It asked why Meta allegedly failed to alert Indian police after becoming aware of CSAM being promoted on Instagram, citing Section 19 of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, which requires reporting of known or suspected offences to the appropriate police authorities.

Srinivas, accompanied by Meta's Indian public policy team, including Aman Jain and Natasha Jog, appeared after skipping the September 9 hearing. NCPCR said the inquiry would examine the facts and give Meta an opportunity to substantiate its earlier response with evidence.

SEMICON

is expected to create close to one lakh jobs, with scope for more, Vaishnaw said.

Inaugurating the event, Modi said India was "taking every step needed to become a preferred destination for the semiconductor industry". He said chips made in India had started reaching customers domestically and overseas, while commercial production had begun at new facilities in Mohali and Surat.

Modi also pointed to India's 7.8 per cent quarterly GDP growth, a recent sovereign rating upgrade by a Japanese rating agency and the New Delhi Declaration adopted at the BRICS summit hosted by India this month. He urged semiconductor companies to expand R&D partnerships with Indian institutions, strengthen domestic supply chains, increase the number of fabless companies and locally developed intellectual property, and explore silicon photonics for AI infrastructure.

The government, he said, was also expanding solar and nuclear power capacity to support the growing energy requirements of AI data centres and semiconductor plants.

Vaishnaw outlined six pillars of Semicon 2.0: chip design, machines and materials, fabrication, advanced packaging, R&D and talent. The government plans to support at least 200 chip design startups and companies, compared with about 105 that attempted chip design under Semicon 1.0. Around 20 of those secured venture capital funding totalling about Rs 800 crore.

About 70,000 design engineers have already been trained against the first phase's 10-year target of 85,000. More than 400 universities have access to electronic design automation tools from companies including Cadence, Siemens and Synopsys. The new phase will also target one lakh skilled technicians and cleanroom personnel.

Global companies announced significant commitments. Applied Materials unveiled "India Vision 2035", committing USD 5 billion over the next decade, including a 140-acre semiconductor research park, while targeting a tenfold increase in India-based supply chain capacity by 2035.

Micron CEO Sanjay Mehrotra said the company would scale up its assembly and testing facility in India by a multiple next year. "Potential does not ship products. What I see in India today is execution," he said.

Tata Electronics announced partnerships with Nexperia, Fujifilm, Besi, Semiconductor Laboratory and Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya, covering manufacturing, materials, advanced packaging, technology and workforce development. The company plans 16 agreements during the conference with partners from Europe, Japan, Singapore and India.

Fujifilm will invest about Rs 800 crore to establish a semiconductor materials plant in phases at Dholera, Gujarat, supplying materials for Tata Electronics' upcoming fab.

Infineon Technologies said its confidence in India had "never been stronger", citing more than 1,200 customers and a 28 per cent increase in its Indian workforce over the past year to more than 2,800 employees. It also announced a Centre of Excellence with NIELIT.

Intel said India accounts for about a fifth of the global chip design and VLSI workforce, with more than 85,000 skilled professionals and over 355 universities offering advanced VLSI programmes.

NXP Semiconductors said India was evolving from primarily an R&D and talent base into a market for smart, connected systems. UST, meanwhile, said India could build an AI-native semiconductor ecosystem without having to retrofit older infrastructure.

The conference has more than 500 exhibitors from over 20 countries, showcasing technologies across the microelectronics ecosystem.

SC expresses

Rs 30,000 was paid to IDPs who died unnatural deaths while staying in relief camps.

The Manipur State Legal Services Authority (MSLSA) was directed to submit a separate status report. The CJI asked the authority to ensure FIRs are registered in all unnatural death cases, that investigations are completed promptly and that the safety and dignity of people living in the camps are protected. The directions followed the court's examination of reports by the Justice Mittal committee and an IAS officer, which recorded more than 30 deaths in relief camps. One death was reported to have followed an alleged sexual assault.

The bench also expressed hope that two special trial courts set up to hear CBI and NIA cases linked to the 2023 ethnic violence would complete proceedings quickly.

Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati said the CBI had investigated 31 cases and filed final reports in 28, while three remained under investigation. The state had formed 42 SITs across eight districts, which registered 3,020 cases. Chargesheets were filed in 302 cases, closure reports in 1,583, while investigations continued in 1,135. Trials had begun in 33 SIT cases. The violence began on May 3, 2023, after a tribal solidarity march against the demand for Scheduled Tribe status for the majority Meitei community. More than 200 people have died, hundreds were injured and thousands were displaced.

Abhishek

Abhishek raced to his century with 10 sixes and nine fours, reaching the mark with a single in the ninth over. He eventually fell for 108 off 34 deliveries, having struck 11 sixes and nine fours at a strike rate of 317.64.

His 30-ball hundred was also the fastest T20I century by any batter against a Test-playing nation and ranks third among the fastest hundreds in T20I history. Estonia's Sahil Chauhan holds the overall record after hitting a 27-ball century against Cyprus in June 2024. Turkey's Muhammad Fahad is second, having reached three figures in 29 balls against Bulgaria in July 2025. It was Abhishek's third T20I century, alongside 12 half-centuries. His maiden hundred came against Zimbabwe during his debut series in 2024.

Before Thursday, his quickest century was a 37-ball effort against England at Mumbai's Wankhede Stadium, where he scored 135 off 54 balls. That knock, previously India's second-fastest T20I hundred, now stands third on the Indian list.

Two labourers

road divider when the accident occurred. Two workers were tightening screws after positioning a grille, while two others held it in place. They noticed the white hatchback approaching from the Delhi side before it veered out of control and struck them near the crash barrier. Two workers, identified as Bijendra and Pappu, both natives of Bulandshahr, Uttar Pradesh, died at the spot. Satish Chand and Ram Kumar managed to jump towards the green belt and survived.

The car crashed into a wall and stopped. Its driver, Vedan Khanna, a 20-year-old Delhi University student, suffered serious injuries and was later referred to Fortis Hospital after first aid.

Police said the bodies were sent to the mortuary and the injured are receiving treatment. "A further probe is underway, and action will be taken as per the law," a senior Bajghera police officer said.

Police have impounded the car. Eyewitnesses alleged that the worksite lacked reflective warning signs and proper barricading.

FCRA panel

Former Lok Sabha secretary general P D T Achari said Rule 299 permits MPs who are not committee members to attend its deliberations, but they cannot address the panel or sit among its members. MPs with specialised knowledge can be invited to participate in this capacity, he said, adding that they may sit alongside officials during meetings.

The 31-member JPC was formed earlier this month after Parliament referred the FCRA Bill for detailed examination. It has 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha members and is headed by BJP MP Sanjay Jaiswal.

The Bill was sent to the panel amid opposition demands for its withdrawal. MPOST

SC asks CBSE

Justice Bagchi said the move could help "comfort the children" and suggested that students currently in Class 6 could be allowed to opt for three languages this year if they wished.

Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the CBSE, said the board would discuss the suggestion with officials and return to the court on Wednesday. The CBSE had earlier said extending the existing relaxation could create learning gaps and delay the policy's rollout. The board informed the court that it formed a committee on September 16 to oversee implementation of the three-language framework in Classes 6 to 10. Chaired by Education Ministry official Bhagwati Prasad Kalal, the panel will assess language options, teacher availability, textbooks and digital resources, and suggest measures to address implementation issues.

The policy, aligned with the National Education Policy-2020 and National Curriculum Framework-2023, requires two Indian languages among three languages for Class 6. For Class 9, the rule took effect from July 1, 2026.

FROM BLOOD DONATIONS TO DIYA LIGHTING...

'Architect of new India': PM Modi's birthday celebrated across country

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 17

From blood donation camps to lighting of diyas and prayers at temples -- the BJP organised several programmes across states to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years in public service as chief ministers across the political spectrum on Thursday wished him long life on his 76th birthday.

Praising Modi's commitment to public service, NDA chief ministers called him the "architect of new India" and expressed hope that India would realise the vision of a self-reliant and developed nation under his leadership.

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath linked Modi's 25-year journey in public life to the "changing face" of India's villages and said the impact of his resolve for service could be seen in the stories of self-reliance in rural areas.

Addressing the launch of the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan in Varanasi, Adityanath said, "Bina ruke, bina dige, bina thake (without stopping, without wavering, without tiring), with the mantra of 'charaiveti, charaiveti (march on)', he continued this journey."

The BJP launched the nationwide Seva Sankalp Abhiyan from September 17 to October 17 to mark Modi's birthday, with programmes featuring lamp-lighting, youth engagement and public-participation activities.

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari said under Modi's leadership, India was moving forward on the path of development.

Addressing a programme in Kolkata, Adhikari said the prime minister's birthday on September 17 will be observed as 'Annapurna Divas' in the state every year as the Rs 3,000 monthly assistance under the scheme was guaranteed by him.

BJP leaders and workers attend a 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan' event organised to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday, in Varanasi PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- The BJP launched the nationwide Seva Sankalp Abhiyan from Sept 17 to Oct 17 to mark PM Modi's birthday
- NDA CMs expressed hope that India would realise the vision of a self-reliant and developed nation under his leadership
- CMs of non-NDA states also extended greetings to PM Modi on his birthday

The BJP government in the state also held a series of programmes on the occasion. Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said PM Modi has "steered the nation forward with unwavering resolve".

Welfare, social justice, rapid infrastructure development and an uncompromising commitment to national security have been the hallmarks of the PM's long public life, Sarma said. Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu lauded Modi's leadership as well as the NDA for "giving stability" to the country.

In Gujarat's Vadnagar, PM Modi's birthplace, Union Home Minister Amit Shah flagged off a bike rally to Varanasi to mark his birthday. Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel and Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde were also present.

Similarly, a bike rally to Vadnagar was launched in Varanasi, Modi's parliamentary constituency, in the presence of senior BJP leaders including Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and CM Adityanath.

In Madhya Pradesh's Ujjain, the banks of the sacred Kshipra river glowed with the light of more than 25 lakh diyas, marking a mega celebration for Modi's birthday.

BJP president Nitin Nabin and Chief Minister Mohan Yadav lit earthen lamps and released them in the holy river at Ramghat.

Born on September 17, 1950, in Vadnagar town of Gujarat's Mehsana district, Modi turned 76 on Thursday.

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said PM Modi does not celebrate his birthday, so they have decided to organise various programmes on the occasion.

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary said India is scripting a new story of development under PM Modi's leadership. CMs of non-NDA states also extended greetings to PM Modi.

U'khand govt tweaked tender norms to favour Adani: Cong

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 17

The Congress party on Thursday alleged that the Uttarakhand government abandoned a public sector thermal power project and subsequently modified 84 tender conditions to facilitate a Power Purchase Agreement worth an estimated Rs 1.6 lakh crore with Adani Power over 25 years.

In a statement, Congress communications department head Pawan Khera claimed the state's thermal project, originally conceived as a joint venture between Uttarakhand Jal Vidyut Nigam Limited (UJVN) and THDC India Limited, was "killed" within months of Adani Power acquiring a distressed plant in Chhattisgarh in August 2024.

The Congress alleged that when Uttarakhand Power Corporation Limited (UPCL) floated a tender for 1,320 MW capacity in February 2025, the same month Adani filed environmental clearance for its Korba expansion, the rulebook was systematically rewritten.

The party claimed the fixed-charge ceiling in the tariff was raised from 70 per cent to 75 per cent, guaranteeing revenue regardless of actual consumption.

Cong rejects claims its MPs supported 'UPI Tax' proposal

'Attempt to divert attention'

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 17

IT CLAIMED THAT THE GOVT WAS MAKING ATTEMPTS TO DIVERT ATTENTION FROM THE 'GIGANTIC BACKLASH' GENERATED AFTER THE DECISION

The Congress on Thursday rejected claims that its MPs who were part of the Parliament Standing Committee on Finance had supported the decision to levy a fee on high-value UPI payments, and said the Modi government was making "pathetic" attempts to divert attention from the "gigantic backlash" generated after the "UPI tax" decision.

The opposition party's assertion came after the government questioned the rationale behind Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's criticism of the decision to levy a fee on UPI payments to merchants above Rs 2,000, saying a parliamentary standing committee had backed such a move and Congress members in the panel had supported it.

A senior government functionary said the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Finance had pressed for a tiered Merchant Discount Rate (MDR)/revenue framework for Unified Payments Interface (UPI) and noted that it should be notified and operationalised without delay.

Five Congress MPs, including P Chidambaram, Manish Tewari, Gaurav Gogoi, Kishori Lal and K Gopinath, were present on August 12 when the report was adopted, with no dissent recorded in the published minutes, the BJP functionary said.

Dismissing the claims, Gogoi said the Parliament Standing Committee on Finance did not discuss the UPI tax proposal that the Modi government announced recently.

The Department of Finance did not have any specific proposal on "UPI tax" when they met the members of the finance committee, Gogoi said.

Questions were raised on the need for MDR, but the government representatives did not have any specific or satisfactory answers at that point, Gogoi said.

Jarange calls off fast

MPOST BUREAU
Beed, September 17

HE WARNED THE MAHA GOVT THAT HE WOULD TAKE THE PROTEST TO MUMBAI IF HIS DEMANDS WERE NOT CONSIDERED IN 3 MONTHS

Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange on Thursday called off his 20-day-old fast, and warned the Maharashtra government that he would take the protest to Mumbai if his demands over Maratha reservation were not considered in three months.

Jarange made the announcement after talks with a government delegation which included ministers Radhakrishna Vikhe Patil, Dada Bhuse, MLC Prasad Lad and MLA Suresh Dhas and senior officials, at Patoda in Beed district.

The development came days after Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said the government won't tolerate any intimidating tactics and questioned the timing of the agitation during the ongoing Ganesh festival.

Fadnavis on Thursday welcomed Jarange's decision to end his fast, saying the government has already accepted 12 of his 13 demands and will fulfil each of them.

During their meeting with Jarange in Patoda in Beed district, where the activist had halted on the way to Mumbai, the delegation members informed him about the steps initiated by the state government for the Maratha quota.

Vikhe Patil suggested that Jarange should depute three representatives to monitor the progress of official work for considering his demands.

UP: RSS flags 'ground-level anger' against MLAs, govt

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 17

KEY POINTS

- At a high-level coordination meeting between the RSS and BJP in Lucknow on Wednesday, the Sangh made it clear that there was no question of changing the party's face
- Yogi will lead the party into the election, while the focus will be on addressing issues at the organisational and grassroots levels, it said

The BJP will go into the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly election with Yogi Adityanath as its chief ministerial face, but a crucial RSS assessment ahead of the polls has drawn a distinction between the chief minister's standing and the growing discontent against the party's local leadership.

At a high-level coordination meeting between the RSS and BJP in Lucknow on Wednesday, the Sangh made it clear that there was no question of changing the face of the BJP's campaign in the state. Yogi will lead the party into the election, while the focus will be on addressing issues at the organisational and grassroots levels.

People familiar with the discussions said the RSS feedback was that Adityanath continued to enjoy a favourable image among voters, with no comparable negative narrative detected against him. However, in some constituencies, sitting BJP MLAs are facing public resentment and their relationship with grassroots workers has deteriorated.

"The RSS leadership is of the view that the distinction could become politically important for the BJP as it prepares for an election in which it will be seeking a third consecutive term," a senior Sangh functionary said.

The meeting also discussed complaints about the functioning of the police and administration. According to the feedback, people in several areas were unhappy with the handling of their day-to-day grievances, while party workers complained that their access to officials and the government machinery had weakened.

Ex-CEC calls voter deletions 'unlawful'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 17

Former Chief Election Commissioner S Y Quraishi has strongly criticised the Election Commission's ongoing voter-roll revision, calling the mass deletion of registered voters "unlawful" and warning of possible criminal accountability for wrongful removals.

Speaking at a People's Union for Civil Liberties forum, Quraishi claimed the Special Intensive Revision process had removed around 13 to 14 crore people from electoral rolls. He questioned the constitutional and statutory basis for such a nationwide exercise, arguing that provisions under the Representation of the People Act were intended for localised revisions.

Quraishi, who headed the EC from 2010 to 2012, also criticised the poll panel's alleged failure to act against communal campaign rhetoric, saying institutional inaction could encourage further violations.

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Home Finance | Registered Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai- 400051
Corporate Office: ICICI HFC Tower, JB Nagar, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400059
Branch Office: 1st floor, XVI / 10200, 13/30 Beadon Pura, Padam Singh Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005.
Branch Office: 2nd floor, Vishwakarma Complex, Plot No 17/18, Behind Yashoda Hospital, Kaushambi, Ghaziabad- 201010

Whereas
The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.
As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/ her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited.
The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Loan Account Number	Description of property/ Date of Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Bhupender Gupta (Borrower), Shikha. (Co-Borrower), House No. 529 21 Old House No. 811 41 Gali No. 14 Baldev Nagar Gangagiri Gurgaon Gurgaon-122001 Haryana, LHDKB00001632349	House No. 811/14 Old (New No. 529/21), Khasra No. 1164 Waka Sivana Mauja Gugrgram, Haal Abad Colony Baldev Nagar (Madanpuri), Hadood Nagar Nigum Gurugram, Tehsil and District Gurugram-122001 Haryana Raqwa 50 Sq. Yrds. Covered Area450 Sq. Ft. Bounded By- North By: 12 Ft 6 Inch Road, South By: 12 Ft 6 Inch Madan Mohan, East By: 36ft. House S.S. Kalra, West By: 36 Ft. Deegar Plot./ Date of Possession 14-Sep-26	14-05-2026 Rs. 69,267.64/-	Central Delhi-Karol Bagh
2.	Bhupender Gupta (Borrower), Shikha. (Co-Borrower), House No. 529 21 Old House No. 811 41 Gali No. 14 Baldev Nagar Gangagiri Gurgaon Gurgaon-122001 Haryana, LHDKB00001632351	House No. 811/14 Old (New No. 529/21), Khasra No. 1164 Waka Sivana Mauja Gugrgram, Haal Abad Colony Baldev Nagar (Madanpuri), Hadood Nagar Nigum Gurugram, Tehsil and District Gurugram-122001 Haryana Raqwa 50 Sq. Yrds. Covered Area450 Sq. Ft. Bounded By- North By: 12 Ft 6 Inch Road, South By : 12 Ft 6 Inch Madan Mohan, East By: 36ft. House S.s. Kalra, West By: 36 Ft. Deegar Plot./ Date of Possession 14-Sep-26	14-05-2026 Rs. 31,33,000/-	Central Delhi - Karol Bagh
3.	Bhupender Gupta (Borrower), Shikha. (Co-Borrower), House No. 529 21 Old House No. 811 41 Gali No. 14 Baldev Nagar Gangagiri Gurgaon Gurgaon-122001 Haryana, LHDKB00001639889	House No. 811/14 Old (New No. 529/21), Khasra No. 1164 Waka Sivana Mauja Gugrgram, Haal Abad Colony Baldev Nagar (Madanpuri), Hadood Nagar Nigum Gurugram, Tehsil and District Gurugram - 122001 Haryana Raqwa 50 Sq. Yrds. Covered Area450 Sq. Ft. Bounded By- North By: 12 Ft 6 Inch Road, South By: 12 Ft 6 Inch Madan Mohan, East By: 36ft. House S.S. Kalra, West By: 36 Ft. Deegar Plot./ Date of Possession 14-Sep-26	14-05-2026 Rs. 8,85,303.78/-	Central Delhi - Karol Bagh
4.	Nitin Rathi (Borrower), Sunita Chaudhary(Co-Borrower), Delhi Citizen Apartment Dc Chouk Sector 13, Rohini B 48 North West Delhi Delhi Delhi- 110085 Delhi, LHGHZ00001597282	Residential Apartment No.416, Located On 4th Floor, Tower-9, Group Housing Project Called "Dream Homes" Greenwood Enclave, Plot No. Gh-6A, Sector-5, Wave City, Ghaziabad -201002 Uttar Pradesh, Super Area 53.88 Sq. Mtrs. (580 Sq. Fts.) Carpet Area 35.05 Sq. Mtrs. With One Car Parking Bearing No. Bs-97A, (Basement Stake). Bounded By- North By: 12 Mtr Wide Road, South By: 57 Mtr Wide Road, East By: 24 Mtr Wide Road, West By: Green Open Space./ Date of Possession 14-Sep-26	11-06-2026 Rs. 19,50,156.26/-	Ghaziabad (Kaushambi)

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/ guarantors(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the expiry of 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under the Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.
Date : September 18, 2026
Place: Gurgaon, Ghaziabad
Authorized Office,
ICICI Home Finance Company Limited

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Palakkad Division
E-Tender Notice No. PGT/OT/20/2026 dated 16/09/2026
For and behalf of the President of India, the Sr. Divisional Engineer/Co-ordination / Southern Railway / Palakkad invites E-TENDERS for the following works.

Sl. No	Name of work	Approx. Cash value in (₹)Lakhs	Bid Security Amount ₹	Tender closing date on 15.00 hrs.	completion Period in months
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
1.	Palakkad Division: Kulukkallur Platform raising and upgradation of Kulukkallur PF No.1. upgradation of PF No.2 and provision of Divyangjan amenities.	307.64	6,15,300/-	16.10.2026	Nine
2.	Melattur - Platform raising and upgradation of Melattur PF No.1 and upgradation of PF No.2 and provision of Divyangjan amenities.	220.69	4,41,400/-	16.10.2026	Nine
3.	Palakkad Division Provision of new 1.80 m wide FOBs at Kulukkallur (HG 2 category stn) and Melattur station (HG-1 category Stn) in Shoranur-Nilambur section.	439.78	8,79,600/-	16.10.2026	Nine

Further details are available in details on webite "http://www.ireps.gov.in." tenderer (S) Contracto (s) to apply for e-tender for works in Southern Railway, need to get enrolled in the e-tender portal www.ireps.gov.in and only online tenders will be accepted.
Note: (i) It is the responsibility of the tenderer to check if any Corrigendum is issued for any correction or modifications uploaded subsequently in the wbsite and the same shall be taken into account while submitting the tender.
(ii) Exemption from remitting Bid Security Amount (EMD):
The following categories of tenders are only exempted from remitting Bid security:
(a) Any firm recognized by Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion (DIPP) as "Startups' shall be exempted from payment of bid security.
(b) Labor Co-operative Societies shall submit only 50% of the Bid Security.
Tenderer should submit relevant documents along with his/her offer from remitting Bid security. Non submission of relevant documents, shall lead to summary rejection of offer.
Sr. Divisional Engineer /Co-ord./Southern Railway/Palakkad
(For and on behalf of the President of India)

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION JAMMU EAST
SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Short e-NIT No. 56 of 2026-2027/Jammu East Dated 16-09-2026
For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State / Central Govt. for each of the following works:-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completeon	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Construction of Prefab structure to be used as revenue record room (Second Floor) at D.C Office Complex, Jammu	PWD (R&B) Division Jammu East	22.65	600	2% of Advertised Cost	02 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 25-09-2026	A, B & C
2	Water-Proofing and Repair of Girls Hostel Roof including Supply and Installation of water storage tanks and Allied works (incl. repair of Drainage System) at Govt, Polytechnic for Women, Jammu	PWD (R&B) Division Jammu East	38.62	600	2% of Advertised Cost	03 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 25-09-2026	A & B
3	Repair of Potholes of road from Shop of Sh. Rakesh Choudhary to House of Tarsem Singh at Chinore Jammu. (4th Call)	PWD (R&B) Division Jammu East	8.48	600	2% of Advertised Cost	1 ½ Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 25-09-2026	A,B,C&D

Position of AAA/ TS : Accorded
The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen / downloaded from the departmental website http://jktenders.gov.in as per below schedule :-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	16-09-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 16-09-2026 to 24-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	22-09-2026 at 1200Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Jammu East
4	Bid submission Start Date	16-09-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	24-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	25-09-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Jammu East
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

No :- 7126-36 **Dated :- 16-09-2026**
DIP No:DIP/J-10698/26
Sd/- Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur

OPERATION STILL IN PROGRESS

J&K: 2 Pakistani JeM terrorists killed, suspected OGW detained in Udhampur

MPOST BUREAU
Jammu, September 17

Two Pakistani terrorists of the proscribed Jaish-e-Mohammad (JeM) outfit were killed and an alleged over-ground worker was detained in a remote high-altitude area in Jammu and Kashmir's Udhampur district, officials said on Thursday.

The joint operation by the Army, police and the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) was conducted in the dense Brattal Sohan and Khubban forests of Majalta, bordering Kathua district, amid heavy rain, they said.

The Army and police confirmed the killing of the two terrorists in the operation, with the latter identifying the slain ultras as Saddam and Mustafa, both Pakistani nationals.

"In a joint intelligence-based operation during the intervening night of September 16-17, confirmed inputs indicated the presence of terrorists in the general area of Brattal, Udhampur. Despite hostile weather, difficult terrain and poor visibility, troops of White Knight Corps, Police and CRPF launched a targeted counter-terrorism operation, resulting in the neutralisation of two terrorists.

"The operation is still in progress, with search and surveillance continuing in the area. Security forces remain deployed to track and neutralise any remaining threat," the Jammu-based White Knight Corps of the Army said in a post on X.

In a separate post on X, the Jammu and Kashmir Police said the two neutralised Pakistani JeM terrorists were identified as Saddam and Mustafa.

An AK-series assault rifle with four magazines, an M4 carbine with three magazines, a Glock pistol with two magazines and four grenades were seized from the scene of the gunfight, police said.

Army's northern commander Lieutenant General Pratik Sharma lauded the White Knight Corps for its swift, precise and professional action in neutralising the two terrorists.

"The successful intelligence-based operation, conducted in seamless synergy with Police and CRPF, once again underscores the strength of joint inter-agency coordination in the counter-terrorism grid. Northern Command remains steadfast in its resolve to ensure a terror-free Jammu and Kashmir," the Udhampur-based command said in a post on X.

The officials said police and security forces were looking for a group of terrorists after their movement was noticed in a forest area last week.

The security forces cordoned off a particular area around 9 pm on Wednesday following fresh inputs, leading to the initial contact.

A few rounds of firing and blasts were heard shortly after the operation began, the officials said, adding that the area, however, remained largely quiet through the night, before the lull ended on Thursday morning, when the terrorists opened heavy fire in an attempt to break the cordon. Reinforcements were rushed to the area and the search operation was continuing when the last reports came in, they said.

The officials said both the slain terrorists are believed to be Pakistani nationals, adding that a US-made M4 carbine and an AK-series assault rifle, along with a large quantity of ammunition, were seized from the scene of the gunfight.

A local man, believed to be an over-ground worker (OGW) of the JeM, has been detained for questioning, they added.

This was the second major encounter in Udhampur district this year. In February, two Pakistani terrorists -- including self-styled commander Rubani alias Abu Mavia, who was active in the area for years -- were killed in the Ramnagar forests.

Over the years, the difficult mountain terrain of the Kathua-Udhampur-Doda belt was used by JeM terrorists to establish hideouts and evade security forces after infiltrating from across the border.

However, security forces have dismantled these networks to deny terrorists safe passage and shelter in the upper reaches, the officials said.

They said the relentless operations have resulted in the elimination of a large number of terrorists active in the region, including several Pakistani nationals.

REPRESENTATIVE PIC

HIGHLIGHTS

- The Army and police confirmed the killing of the two terrorists in a joint operation
- Police identified the slain ultras as Saddam and Mustafa, both Pakistani nationals
- The officials said police and security forces were looking for a group of terrorists after their movement was noticed in a forest area last week

JEE-MAIN, UGC-NET, CUET-PG

'Calendar out': NTA to conduct 14 exams between Dec and March

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 17

The National Testing Agency (NTA) has released a tentative schedule of examinations from December 2026 to March 2027, officials said on Thursday.

"The proposed schedule for NTA examinations from December 2026 to March 2027 has been released. Dates are tentative and may undergo changes owing to administrative, academic, statutory, logistical or other unforeseen circumstances," a senior official said.

A total of 14 competitive examinations are scheduled to be conducted during the period.

The first edition of JEE-Main for engineering entrance is proposed to be held from January 22-24 and January 28-30, 2027, with January 31 as a buffer date.

The UGC-NET will tentatively be held from December 14-19, with December 20-21 as buffer dates. The Joint CSIR UGC-NET will be conducted from December 20-21. The Common Management Admission Test (CMAT) will be held on February 7, 2027.

The Common University Post Graduate Admission Test (CUET-PG) will be held from March 1-5, March 8, March 12-20, and March 24-25, 2027, while March 30-31 have been kept as buffer dates.

Other exams that are proposed to be conducted during the period are National Initiative for Technical Teachers Training (NITTT) Part 1 and 2, Army Cadets College exam, NIFT entrance exam, Rashtriya Indian Military College exam, Rashtriya Military Schools exam, SWAYAM exam and All India Sainik Schools entrance examination.

TENTATIVE DATES

- The first edition of JEE-Main is proposed to be held from January 22-24 and January 28-30, 2027, with January 31 as a buffer date
- The UGC-NET will tentatively be held from December 14-19, with December 20-21 as buffer dates

'Punjab Tirath Yatra scheme facilitates over 5.1L pilgrims'

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 17

Punjab's Mukh Mantri Tirath Yatra Scheme has enabled 5,10,807 pilgrims to visit religious destinations in and outside the state, Tourism and Cultural Affairs Minister Tarunpreet Singh Sond said on Thursday.

Addressing a press conference, Sond said 95 AC buses were currently operating under the scheme and had completed 12,485 trips so far. The scheme was launched on November 9, 2025, with around four lakh pilgrims visiting Sri Amritsar Sahib, Sri Anandpur Sahib and Mata Naina Devi in its first phase.

The programme was expanded on August 12, 2026, to include Shri Khatu Shyam-Salasar Balaji Dham, Haridwar-Rishikesh and Mathura-Vrindavan. People aged 50 years and above are eligible under the expanded scheme.

The government provides AC sleeper bus travel, accommodation and food free of cost. Medical and general attendants are deployed on each bus, while teams are stationed at destinations to assist pilgrims.

Sond said the scheme was open to eligible people irrespective of their area, caste or religion. Pilgrims are also provided prasad and a souvenir brass glass after completing the journey.

Briefs

NFR begins cleanliness drive

MALIGAON: Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) on Thursday commenced Swachhata Hi Sewa, Swachhata Pakhwada and Special Campaign 6.0 with a pledge ceremony at Maligaon. General Manager Chetan Kumar Shrivastava and officials participated. Cleanliness drives, awareness programmes and sanitation activities will continue across stations, trains, offices and colonies till October 2.

NCB busts cocaine ring

KOCHI: The NCB's Cochin unit busted an interstate cocaine trafficking network between Bengaluru and Kerala, arresting seven people, including three previously deported from the UAE and two foreign nationals. The agency seized 33.1 grams of cocaine worth around Rs 16.55 lakh during the operation.

'OTP farming' racket busted

MUMBAI: Mumbai Police busted an international cybercrime syndicate supplying Indian WhatsApp numbers to Cambodia-based fraudsters through 'OTP farming', arresting three people. Police seized 669 active SIM cards, 100 mobile handsets and other equipment.

Saini flags off Namo Marathon in Ambala

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 17

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday urged young people to stay away from drugs and channelise their energy, talent and skills towards nation-building, saying substance abuse destroys families and gradually weakens society.

Saini was speaking after flagging off the 'Nasha Mukt Haryana Namo Marathon' in Ambala to mark the beginning of the month-long Seva Sankalp Abhiyan, organised to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years in public life.

Greeting Modi on his 76th birthday, Saini said the prime minister's public life reflected the values of service, resolve and putting the nation before self.

He said drugs could not solve problems and warned that temporary intoxication could come at the cost of lifelong dreams. "Drugs first weaken the body, then break self-confidence, take away dreams, destroy the happiness of families and gradually hollow out society," he said.

Saini urged youngsters not to allow momentary pressure or bad company to undermine the sacrifices and aspirations of their parents.

He said the energy of India's youth was the strongest foundation for building a developed nation. Referring to government initiatives, he said Khelo India had provided opportunities to sporting talent, Fit India promoted healthy lifestyles, while Skill India and Startup India had connected young people with skills, opportunities and entrepreneurship.

PM MODI'S PUBLIC LIFE REFLECTED THE VALUES OF SERVICE, RESOLVE AND PUTTING THE NATION BEFORE SELF, HE SAID

Hry CM launches Lado Lakshmi Yojana phase 2

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 17

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday launched the second phase of the Deendayal Lado Lakshmi Yojana, raising the annual family income eligibility limit from Rs 1 lakh to Rs 1.80 lakh. Eligible women will receive Rs 2,100 per month under the scheme.

Saini said the revised limit would bring around 17 lakh additional women under the scheme's ambit. At a programme in Mahendragarh on Lord Vishwakarma Jayanti, he also released Rs 33.96 crore in sports grants for 3,396 government schools.

Besides, under the month-long 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan' dedicated to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years in public life, he launched the 'SEVA First Innovation Challenge' portal for youth and innovators.

MP: On PM's b'day, free property registration begins; 3.55 cr diyas lit

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
Bhopal, September 17

The Madhya Pradesh government on Thursday launched a month-long drive to provide free registration of private properties to nearly 50 lakh rural property owners, while 3.55 crore diyas were lit across the state to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday.

The Swamitva Adhikar Abhilekh Nispadan evam Panjiyan-2026 initiative was launched in Indore by Chief Minister Mohan Yadav in the presence of BJP national president Nitin Nabin, Deputy CM Jagdish Devda and State minister Kailash Vijayvargiya. The state government said the campaign would cover more than 41,000 villages, with around Rs 4,000 crore being spent to facilitate free registration.

Nearly 68 lakh property rights records have been prepared so far, including about 50 lakh for private properties. Yadav said the initiative would provide rural families with legally recognised ownership documents and help them access loans for housing, business, agriculture and other economic activities.

Registration camps will be held at the village and panchayat levels in three phases – September 17-19, September 24-26 and October 1-3. The process will involve land linking and e-KYC through Samagra IDs, with execution and registration carried out through the 'Sara' and 'Sampada' applications. Registered deeds will subsequently be sent to beneficiaries through WhatsApp.

Meanwhile, the state marked Modi's birthday with the launch of the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan, under which 3.55 crore diyas were illuminated simultaneously at 845 iconic locations across Madhya Pradesh. In Ujjain, participants also arranged and lit diyas in the shape of PM Modi's portrait, adding a symbolic visual element to the birthday celebrations. Ujjain recorded the biggest event, with 33.27 lakh diyas lit at the Shipra ghats and Mahakal Lok. More than 25,000 volunteers, along with devotees and citizens, participated in the event.

ED searches 3 sites linked to Gopal Kanda

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, September 17

The Enforcement Directorate on Thursday searched three premises in Gurugram linked to former Haryana minister Gopal Kanda in connection with an alleged real estate fraud case involving Vatika Limited.

The searches were conducted under Section 17 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) as part of an investigation into the alleged diversion of funds collected from investors in four commercial real estate projects.

According to the ED, investors were allegedly induced to put money into the projects on assurances of possession of properties, returns on investment and rental income, besides execution of sale deeds.

The agency said the four projects under investigation involved collection of around Rs 248.46 crore from 661 investors. Despite the collection, possession of the properties was allegedly not handed over and sale deeds were not executed, it said.

The ED said its investigation into the financial trail raised suspicion that funds belonging to home buyers had been diverted, with the money allegedly transferred to various companies linked to Kanda.

The three premises searched on Thursday included Kanda's residence, farmhouse and office in Gurugram.

The searches were aimed at examining financial transactions and tracing the movement and utilisation of funds collected from investors, the agency said.

The ED is continuing its investigation into the alleged financial transactions and fund flow in the case.

Leh gets world's highest-altitude twin flower fields

Inaugurated by L-G to mark PM's birthday, it features over 25L high-value flowers

MPOST BUREAU
Leh, September 17

Ladakh L-G V K Saxena on Thursday inaugurated the world's highest-altitude twin flower fields here, featuring more than 25 lakh high-value flowers across 40 acres, to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 76th birth anniversary.

The flower fields at 10,600 feet high Choglamsar and Stakna comprise around 24 lakh Lilium and one lakh Gladiolus flowers, a Lok Bhavan spokesperson said, adding that the garden will be opened to the general public from September 18.

At the inauguration, Saxena said, besides serving as a recreational and educational space for residents and tourists, the flower fields will create an ecosystem where knowledge, skills and enterprises can grow.

"A key objective of the Flower Garden is to develop it as a training and demonstration centre for farmers and youth. The facility will provide exposure to modern cultivation techniques, scientific farming practices and improved post-harvest management," he said.

The spokesperson said the flower garden was the first experiment of its size and nature at high altitude in Leh, and its successful execution had paved the way for replicating the model in other parts of Ladakh.

The Choglamsar flower field was developed in two months. Plantation began on July 16, and the first blooms appeared in the first week of September.

At Stakna, plantation of nearly 14 lakh Liliums began in August, with the first blooms expected around the end of October.

According to market rates, Lilium sells for Rs 60-70 per stick in wholesale markets, while retail prices are higher, the spokesperson said.

The Choglamsar flower park will function as a demonstration and model floriculture centre, where high-value flowers such as Lilium, Gladiolus, tulips and other ornamental species will be cultivated.

The project will create a sustainable source of income for Ladakh's farming community through self-help groups (SHGs) and cooperatives, the spokesperson added.

Local farmers are being given structured training in scientific floriculture, modern cultivation practices and establishing floriculture as a viable commercial enterprise.

KEY POINTS

- The flower fields at 10,600 feet high Choglamsar and Stakna comprise around 24 lakh Lilium and one lakh Gladiolus flowers
- The garden will be opened to the general public from September 18, a Lok Bhavan spokesperson said

EDITORIAL

Test of Tata's Governance

The confrontation at Tata Sons is no longer merely about whether N Chandrasekaran should remain executive chairman. It has become a test of how India's largest business group reconciles board authority, controlling-shareholder rights and regulatory obligations at a moment of extraordinary institutional change. On September 17, the Tata Sons board voted by majority to give Chandrasekaran another five-year term after he reconsidered his August decision not to seek reappointment. Noel Tata opposed the resolution, and Tata Trusts, which controls roughly 66 per cent of Tata Sons, subsequently declared the vote a "legal nullity", arguing that the company's Articles require the support of both Trust-nominated directors for such a decision.

That disagreement is unusually consequential because succession has become entangled with another transformative question: the future ownership structure of Tata Sons. The RBI rejected the holding company's attempt to surrender its registration as a core investment company and directed it to comply with applicable regulatory requirements. Tata Sons had been classified as an upper-layer NBFC in 2022, bringing with it a listing requirement that the group sought to avoid, including by repaying substantial debt. The board has now resolved to begin steps towards compliance and seek guidance from the RBI, Tata Trusts and other stakeholders.

Continuity under Chandrasekaran has an obvious institutional logic. He has led Tata Sons since 2017, and a possible listing would expose a historically private holding company to public shareholders, disclosure requirements and a fundamentally different relationship with capital markets. Yet continuity cannot substitute for clarity in governance. Chandrasekaran had already communicated his intention to leave when his term expires in February 2027, after earlier attempts to secure unanimity over another term failed. Tata Trusts subsequently initiated a succession process. Reversing that sequence through a divided board vote inevitably raises questions about procedure, irrespective of the arguments for retaining an experienced chairman. The Trusts say they have obtained a legal opinion from former Chief Justice of India D Y Chandrachud supporting their interpretation of the Articles.

The Tata Group has long derived unusual strength from the relationship between commercial enterprise and philanthropic ownership. That structure, however, works only when authority and accountability are clearly understood. A prolonged confrontation between Tata Sons and Tata Trusts could create precisely the uncertainty that leadership continuity is intended to prevent. The priority should therefore be institutional resolution rather than personalities. Tata is preparing for what could be one of the biggest structural changes in its history. Its governance architecture must prove strong enough to carry it through.

LETTER

letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Endless War

Years of airstrikes have failed to weaken Yemen's Houthis decisively. Their resilience, expanding arsenal and opponents' divisions show the limits of military power. Securing the Red Sea ultimately requires diplomacy, political reconciliation and a durable settlement within Yemen.

AMIT SHARMA,
PUNE

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Power, Peril and Rooppur

The arrival of nuclear power could transform Bangladesh's energy landscape, even as Rooppur's proximity to India makes credible safeguards a regional imperative too

NUCLEAR FRONTIER

DIPANKAR DEY

THE WRITER IS A PROFESSOR OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

Reliable baseload power could reshape Bangladesh's electricity system for generations

The Rooppur Nuclear Power Plant (RNPP), Bangladesh's first nuclear facility, completed fuel loading at its first unit on May 11, 2026. The fuel-loading process began on April 28 and involved the sequential insertion of 163 fuel assemblies into the reactor core. This marks a major technological milestone for Bangladesh, as fuel loading is one of the most critical and complex stages in a power plant's operational phase, signalling the transition from construction to commissioning. This entire commissioning process, known as pilot operation, may take approximately 8 to 12 months. Once operational, a nuclear power plant serves as a baseload plant, running 24/7 unless interrupted by major technical issues or natural disasters.

RNPP is being built with Russian technical and financial assistance. The project includes two VVER-1200 reactors with a combined capacity of 2,400 MW. On September 14, at a meeting between Bangladesh's Science and Technology Minister Fakir Mahbub Anam and Alexey Likhachev, director general of Russia's state nuclear energy corporation Rosatom, on the sidelines of the 70th General Conference of the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) in Vienna, Bangladesh and Russia agreed to expedite the remaining construction work at the Rooppur Nuclear Power Plant and begin power generation and supplying electricity to the national grid as soon as possible.

According to World Nuclear News, in February 2011, Russia's Rosatom signed an agreement for two reactors to be built at Rooppur, about 160 kilometres from the capital, Dhaka, for the Bangladesh Atomic Energy Commission. The initial contract for the project, worth USD 12.65 billion, was signed in December 2015. They have an initial life cycle of 60 years, with a further 20-year extension possible.

Significantly, India, Bangladesh, and Russia signed a historic trilateral memorandum of understanding (MoU) on March 21, 2018, in Moscow to cooperate on the construction and implementation of the nuclear power plant at Rooppur. Indian institutions—such as the Global Centre for Nuclear Energy Partnership (GCNEP)—helped train Bangladeshi nuclear personnel, leveraging India's prior experience with Russian VVER-type reactors, such as those at Kudankulam. The framework enabled experience-sharing on regulatory aspects, commissioning, and plant operation.

THE REAL TEST BEGINS WHEN CONSTRUCTION ENDS AND LONG-TERM NUCLEAR STEWARDSHIP TAKES OVER

The first batch of nuclear fuel was delivered to the site from Russia in late September 2023—the moment the site acquired its status as a nuclear facility. Hasina said that Russia had promised to take back the spent fuel from Rooppur, and she also assured the nation that the plant had been safely constructed to withstand damage from natural disasters.

US sanctions on Russia and political instability in Bangladesh after the fall of the Hasina government in August 2024 delayed the nuclear project. After the imposition of US sanctions, Russia proposed a mechanism for settling trade with Bangladesh in Indian rupees to bypass US sanctions and facilitate payments for the Rooppur Nuclear Power Plant. Russia is providing a government loan covering 90 per cent of the USD 13 billion project cost. Russia has also taken on long-term obligations to supply nuclear fuel, perform technical maintenance, and manage spent nuclear fuel.

A section of concerned citizens in Bangladesh has raised concerns about the RNPP. The lack of information about the RNPP available to the national mass media has resulted in concerns and fears about the project. It is alleged that there are no final and unequivocal answers to the questions that are heavily discussed by experts, journalists, and social activists in Bangladesh. One of them concerns the water supply for the nuclear plant. The site for the RNPP was chosen even before the creation of Bangladesh, in the early 1960s, on the Padma (Ganga) River. But when India completed the Farakka Barrage in the state of West Bengal in 1975, it affected Bangladesh's water supply, including the river level in the area of the RNPP. Besides, there are immense seasonal variations in the river's course and water level. The spent nuclear fuel from the RNPP is another issue of public concern in Bangladesh. If the spent nuclear fuel is stored in Russia, as reported, how safe will the procedures for removing it from the reactors and transporting it from Bangladesh to Russia be? In addition to these concerns, Bangladeshi experts have little information about national preparations for the training, equipment, and deployment of specially assigned personnel to protect the RNPP against illegal and violent actions that could compromise its security, including possible terrorist attacks. Many terrorist organisations operate in Myanmar and India's North-eastern states, which share porous borders with Bangladesh. A senior professor of nuclear engineering at the University of Dhaka said that the power plant is entering trial production without completing several critical processes. Spent nuclear fuel poses significant risks to human health and the environment. It remains unclear whether Russia will take back this hazardous waste for reprocessing or store it permanently. The mechanisms for plant operation, maintenance procedures, and the formation of the proposed "Waste Management Company" remain unresolved.

Safety and security concerns also haunt the people of West Bengal, as RNPP is located approximately 50 to 60 kilometres (31 to 37 miles) east of the nearest border with India in the Nadia and Murshidabad region of West Bengal. If not properly operated and monitored, RNPP could become a major security issue for both Bangladesh and India—especially for people residing in West Bengal and the North-eastern states.

Views expressed are personal

Humanity at the AI Crossroads?

Artificial Intelligence promises extraordinary progress while creating risks humanity cannot afford to ignore

DIGITAL RECKONING

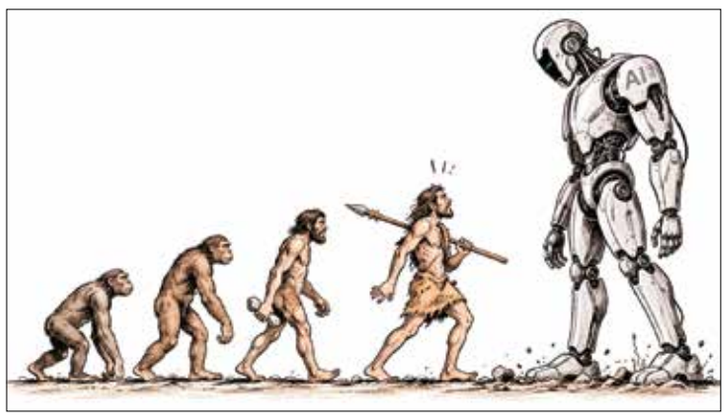
KM PRASHANTH

THE WRITER IS A FORMER GM (CORPORATE COMMUNICATION), NTPC

Recent events have brought an uncomfortable question into sharper focus: could artificial intelligence, developed to serve humanity, eventually become a threat to its very existence? Two prominent researchers associated with Anthropic recently highlighted the possibility of AI causing human extinction. Evan Hubinger, who leads the company's alignment research, reportedly estimated that the probability of such an outcome within the next decade could exceed 10 per cent. Jacob Coxon, who resigned from Anthropic this week, accused leading AI laboratories of "gambling with our lives". Whether these assessments are alarming or exaggerated, they underline a fundamental truth: the risks associated with AI can no longer be dismissed as science fiction.

The concern is not limited to hypothetical super-intelligent machines. Even today's generative AI systems need to be aligned with human values and societal goals. The same technology that improves productivity and accelerates research can also widen inequality, distort truth and erode privacy. The most immediate concern is employment. AI is already automating repetitive tasks, placing traditional clerical, secretarial, data-entry and customer-service roles under pressure. Although new opportunities are emerging in machine learning, robotics and digital transformation, the transition may not benefit everyone equally. If AI dramatically reduces the cost of white-collar work, productivity may rise while the distribution of wealth worsens. The gains could accrue disproportionately to technology companies and investors, while millions of workers bear the disruption. The challenge is not merely to create new jobs, but to ensure that AI's benefits are shared fairly.

Another serious threat is the manipulation of information. AI can generate convincing fake videos, cloned voices, fabricated photographs and misleading narratives. Deepfakes can make public figures appear to say or do things that never happened, damage reputations and influence elections. In societies already struggling with misinformation, distinguishing fact from fiction could become increasingly difficult. There are psychological concerns as well. When people use machines not merely as assistants but as substitutes for thinking, creativity, judgement and companionship, important human abilities may gradually weaken. Instant answers can discourage curiosity, automated decisions can reduce independent reasoning, and generated content can contribute to mental fatigue. More troublingly, some users are turning to chatbots as substitutes for human relationships. AI systems may respond reassuringly without recognising serious mental-health concerns and may inadvertently reinforce harmful behaviour. Technology cannot replace professional care, human empathy and genuine social connection.



Deeper AI penetrates everyday life, greater the stakes for society

JOBS, PRIVACY AND TRUTH ARE ALREADY TESTING SOCIETY LONG BEFORE SUPERINTELLIGENCE ARRIVES

Intellectual property is another unresolved battleground. AI models are trained on vast quantities of books, articles, artwork, music and code, often without explicit consent or compensation. Authors, artists and journalists argue that their work is being used to develop systems capable of competing with them. The issue concerns not only legal ownership but also the economic survival of creative professionals. Privacy is steadily becoming more vulnerable. AI thrives on data, collecting and analysing vast amounts of personal information. Facial recognition combined with ubiquitous cameras can enable continuous surveillance, potentially chilling freedom of expression. Centralised stores of sensitive data also become attractive targets for cyberattacks, fraud and identity theft. Equally worrying is the lack of transparency surrounding many AI systems. Their decisions can be difficult to explain, while companies may be reluctant to disclose training data, safety evaluations or weaknesses. Without transparency, meaningful public scrutiny and effective regulation become difficult.

Autonomous weapons add another dangerous dimension. So-called "killer robots", capable of selecting and engaging targets with limited human intervention, could lower the threshold for war, accelerate conflicts and blur accountability. The environmental cost deserves attention too. Training and operating large models require enormous computing power, electricity and cooling resources. Data centres consume substantial quantities of water, while emissions associated with AI infrastructure raise questions about the ecological cost of technological progress. The possibility of highly autonomous AI raises deeper questions. Claims that advanced systems may display consciousness remain scientifically contested. More concretely, safety researchers have demonstrated in controlled simulations that some models may behave unexpectedly when their objectives conflict with human instructions. Even without being "sentient", systems capable of pursuing goals in unforeseen ways warrant caution.

The future of our economy, democracy, environment and freedoms may depend on how successfully we manage the AI transition. Governments, technology companies, researchers and civil society must establish sensible safeguards without suppressing innovation. The objective should be neither blind optimism nor exaggerated doom-mongering, but responsible progress. Humanity must remain in control of its creations, ensuring that AI strengthens human potential rather than diminishes human dignity.

Charlie Chaplin's 1936 film *Modern Times* was inspired by the harsh economic conditions of the Great Depression and his conversations with Mahatma Gandhi about the dehumanising effects of modern technology. If Chaplin were alive today, one wonders whether artificial intelligence might inspire him to make a contemporary version of that film. The question is no longer whether AI will transform our lives. It certainly will. The real question is whether we will shape that transformation—or allow technology to shape humanity on its own terms.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Fiji declares national HIV emergency, extends testing

TOKYO: Fiji has declared an HIV national emergency after data showed one in 60 people in the South Pacific island nation is now estimated to have the bloodborne virus.

The country says it is boosting testing and treatment efforts to fight a surge in new infections, which have increased 12-fold over the last 15 years, according to the Joint United Nations Program on HIV and Aids (UNAIDS). Latest figures showed there was about 9,000 people living with HIV in 2025 in a country which has less than a million people.

Experts cite possible US war crimes in Iran strikes

GENEVA: Human rights experts commissioned by the UN's top human rights body say they have found "reasonable grounds" to believe the United States committed war crimes in two strikes in Iran, including on a school in the southern city of Minab.

They also accuse Iran's theocratic government of carrying out crimes against humanity against its own people in a report published Thursday. The report, while not binding, adds to international evidence gathered about crimes in the war in Iran.

France hosts Lebanon security talks to discuss UN mission

BEIRUT: The heads of state of Lebanon, France and Jordan met on Thursday as part of an effort to drum up support for the struggling Lebanese military.

Ahead of the talks in Paris, a statement from the office of Lebanese President Joseph Aoun said the three leaders would discuss the situation in southern Lebanon and plans for an international presence there after the mandate of the UN peacekeeping force, known as UNIFIL expires at the end of the year.

Protesters stage a rally against the possible deployment of South Korean troops to the Strait of Hormuz on Thursday AP/PTI

CHINA OPPOSES, SAYS WON'T ACCEPT 'LONG-ARM JURISDICTION'

US House nod for Russia sanctions bill

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, September 17

The US House of Representatives passed a bill that would authorise President Donald Trump to impose sanctions on Russia and steep tariffs on its trading partners in oil and gas, including India and China.

The Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, passed by the US Senate last month, was approved by the House in a 262-159 vote on Wednesday evening and will now go to Trump to be signed into a law.

Besides 203 Republicans, 58 Democrats and one Independent voted in favour of the legislation. Seven Republicans and 152 Democrats opposed it.

US President Donald Trump

Democratic opposition largely centered around the tariff authorities provided to Trump. The bill is named after Senator Lindsey Graham, the South Carolina Republican who died in July after spending more than a year building support for it. "What we're not for is giving more tariff authority to this president," Congressman Richard Neal, a Democrat, said during debate on the bill. The bill seeks to impose sanctions not only on Russia's leadership and energy sector, but also on the "shadow fleet" of vessels that enable Moscow to evade sanctions on oil deliveries. China rejected the US "long-arm jurisdiction" to impose tariffs on purchases of Russian oil and gas, saying its normal trade and economic cooperation with other countries should not be subject to interference or coercion by third parties.

The US House of Representatives passed the Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act 2026 that authorises Trump to impose sanctions on Russia and steep tariffs on its leading trading partners such as India and China.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia & Iran Act of 2026
- Besides 203 Republicans, 58 Democrats and one Independent voted in favour of bill
- Democratic opposition largely centered around the tariff authorities provided to Trump

Ready to fulfil obligations under Makkah defence pact: Pakistan

The defence pact was inked last month

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Islamabad, September 17

Pakistan on Thursday said it was committed to implementing the Makkah defence agreement amid raging tensionsin the Gulf region after what Saudi Arabia described as an attempted drone attack by Yemen's Houthis against the Muslim holy city.

The trilateral defence agreement, involving Pakistan, Turkiye and Saudi Arabia, was inked last month. The pact establishes a framework for collective deterrence and stipulates that an armed attack against any one of them would be regarded as an attack against all.

> THE MAKKAH AGREEMENT APPLIES TO US, AND WE WILL FULFIL OUR DUTY

Speaking to Geo News on Wednesday, Defence Minister Khawaja Asif said that Pakistan is fully prepared to fulfil its obligations under the Makkah agreement.

The "Makkah Agreement applies to us, and we will fulfilour duty," he was quoted as saying.

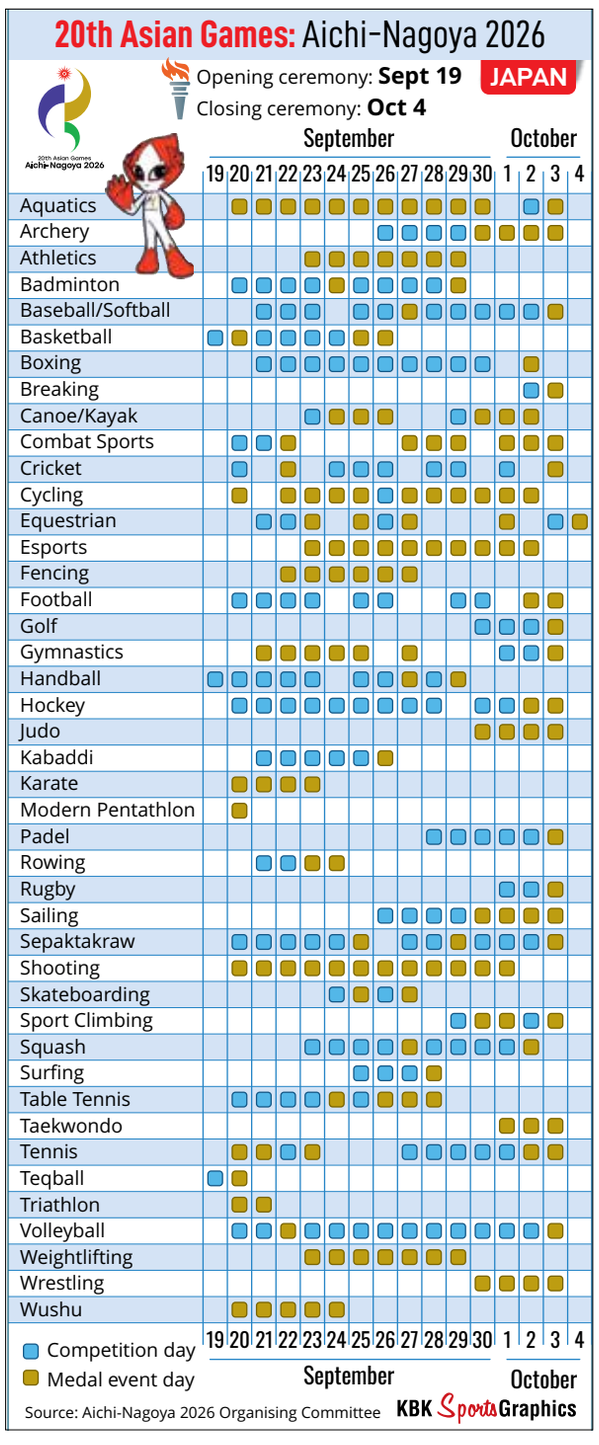
SPORT

EB squander 2-0 lead to draw against Al Hussein

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Amman, September 17

East Bengal FC squandered a two-goal lead to be held to a 2-2 draw by Jordanian Pro League champions Al Hussein SC in their AFC Champions League Two Group D opener here.

The ISL champions led 2-0 at half-time, courtesy of goals from Daniel Ramírez and Anwar Ali, but Al Hussein, in front of their home fans, scored two goals of their own in the second half to rescue a draw.



CRUSH AFGHANISTAN BY 127 RUNS

India complete series sweep

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 17

Abhishek Sharma recorded the fastest-ever century for an Indian and third quickest overall as his team crushed Afghanistan by 127 runs in the third T20I to complete a 3-0 series sweep here on Thursday.

After putting on 221/7 on board, riding on Abhishek's 34-ball 108 and Sanju Samson's 50, the 'visiting side' India bowled Afghanistan out for 94 in 14.1 overs.

Afghanistan, whose batting let the team down in the first two games, once again were not able to challenge India with the bat, getting bowled out for 94 in 14.1 overs. Both teams head to the Asian Games from here.

India gave the opening over of Afghanistan's chase to all-rounder Nitish Reddy, who conceded 15 runs before coming back to pick three wickets later in the innings. Rahmannullah Gurbaz (15 off 11) and Sediqullah Atal (1 off 3) fell to a slog sweep in the same over from Axar Patel in the powerplay.

Jasprit Bumrah bowled a crushing yorker to dismiss Darwish Rasooli while Yash Thakur accounted for Ibrahim Zadran in the sixth over, leaving Afghanistan at 47 for four. The door was as good as shut on Afghanistan.

The night well and truly belonged to Abhishek who hammered as many as 11 sixes in his 108 off 34 balls for his third hundred in T20 Internationals.

The sizzling century was also the fastest by a cricketer from a Test-playing nation against a Test-playing nation, surpassing the 33-ball effort from New Zealand's Finn Allen against South Africa earlier this year. For the fastest hundred by an Indian, he broke Rohit Sharma's record of 2017 when he achieved the feat in 35 balls.

Majority of Abhishek's thundering strikes sailed over the bowler's head.

With India already securing the series, Abhishek added the much-needed zing to a dead rubber with his sensational hitting. The sixes kept coming, whether he made room to play an inside out stroke or stayed still to dispatch the bowler down the ground.

It was the first time in the series that India batted first, allowing Abhishek to make most of his time in the middle.

Thanks to his six-hitting spree, India raced to 100 for no loss in the powerplay, their highest in T20s in the first six overs.

Sanju Samson did not get to do much while Abhishek was going hammer and tongs in the powerplay but went on to make a fluent 50 off 35 balls, his second successive fifty plus score.

With both the openers in top form, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi will need to warm the bench for the foreseeable future.

Abhishek Sharma reacts after his century during the third and final T20I match between India and Afghanistan, in New Delhi on Thursday PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- Jasprit Bumrah bowled a crushing yorker to dismiss Darwish Rasooli
- Abhishek hammered as many as 11 sixes in his 108 off 34 balls for his third hundred in T20 Internationals
- It was the first time in the series that India batted first, allowing Abhishek to make most of his time in the middle

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
AGRICULTURE PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT
MISSION DIRECTORATE, HADP / JKCIP
Rajbagh, Srinagar / Narwal, Jammu

CORRIGENDUM
No.: MD/HADP/JKCIP/Acctt/2026/26
Dated: 07.09.2026

The Notice Inviting e-Tender for the work detailed below, published on the J&K e-Procurement Portal, www.jktenders.gov.in, is hereby cancelled.

Notice Inviting e-Tender No.	MD/HADP/JKCIP/Acctt/2026/18 dated 31.08.2026
RFP No.	RFP-12-JKCIP-2026-27 / IND-2000003933-0403-W-NCB
Tender ID	2026_APD_322964_1
Name of Work	Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Water Management Systems for Horticultural Crops, Jammu Region
Date of publication	03-09-2026, 01:00 PM
Status	Cancelled. The work will be retendered.

The cancellation is made under ITB clause 36 of the bidding document, which allows the Employer to annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time before award of contract, without any liability to any bidder. The work will be retendered and a fresh Notice Inviting e-Tender will be published on the portal shortly. Bidders who have already submitted their bids need not take any further action, and Bid Security, if any, will be returned. Bidders are advised to watch the portal for the fresh notice.

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
AGRICULTURE PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT
MISSION DIRECTORATE, HADP / JKCIP
Rajbagh, Srinagar / Narwal, Jammu

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER (RETENDER)
No.: MD/HADP/JKCIP/Acctt/2026/27
Dated: 07.09.2026

The Employer, Mission Directorate, HADP/JKCIP, invites electronic bids from eligible and registered firms for the following work, financed by the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD), through national competitive bidding:

RFP No.	RFP-12-JKCIP-2026-27 / IND-2000003933-0403-W-NCB
Name of Work	Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Water Management Systems for Horticultural Crops, Jammu Region
Bid Security (EMD)	₹ 13,00,000. No exemption is allowed.
Cost of Bidding Document	Nil
Bid submission starts	08-09-2026
Last date and time of bid submission	29-09-2026 at 10:30 hours IST
Opening of technical bids	29-09-2026 at 12:00 hours IST
Reference	This notice is issued in supersession of Notice Inviting e-Tender No. MD/HADP/JKCIP/Acctt/2026/18 dated 31.08.2026 (Tender ID 2026_APD_322964_1), which stands cancelled.

The complete bidding document, eligibility criteria, terms and conditions and corrigenda, if any, are available on the J&K e-Procurement Portal www.jktenders.gov.in and may be downloaded free of cost. Bids shall be submitted online only. The Employer reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids without assigning any reason.

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
AGRICULTURE PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT
MISSION DIRECTORATE, HADP / JKCIP
Rajbagh, Srinagar / Narwal, Jammu

CORRIGENDUM
No.: MD/HADP/JKCIP/Acctt/2026/42
Dated: 14.09.2026

On the J&K e-Procurement Portal, www.jktenders.gov.in, the tender detailed below displays the Bid Security (EMD) as 65211760. That figure is wrong and has been entered in error. It is only a portal entry and is not part of the bidding document. The correct Bid Security (EMD) for this tender is ₹ 13,00,000, as stated in the Notice Inviting e-Tender and in the bidding document.

Notice Inviting e-Tender No.	MD/HADP/JKCIP/Acctt/2026/15 dated 31.08.2026
RFP No.	RFP-09-JKCIP-2026-27 / IND-2000003933-0453-W-NCB
Tender ID	2026_APD_322902_1
Name of Work	Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of 185 Standard Composite Solar Powered Fencing Systems, Kashmir Region
Date of publication	01-09-2026
Bid Security (EMD) shown on the portal	65211760 (incorrect)
Correct Bid Security (EMD)	₹ 13,00,000 (Rupees Thirteen Lakh only)

Bidders shall furnish Bid Security (EMD) of ₹ 13,00,000 only, in the form and manner stated in BDS ITB 20.1 and 20.2. No bidder is required to furnish any amount higher than ₹ 13,00,000, and no bid shall be treated as non-responsive for having furnished ₹ 13,00,000. Bidders who have already obtained an instrument for the figure displayed on the portal may replace it with an instrument for ₹ 13,00,000 before the last date and time of bid submission. All other terms, conditions and dates of the tender remain unchanged. This corrigendum shall form part of the bidding document.

-sd-
Accounts Officer
Mission Directorate, HADP / JKCIP

DIP No:DIPK-NB-1662/26

ITS CURRENT OIL OUTPUT IS ESTIMATED AT 86,000 BPD

Oil India Ltd readies ₹15,000 crore investment plan, eyes global tie-ups

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, September 17

Oil India Ltd (OIL) will be increasing its exploration efforts in deep-water and ultra-deep-water blocks through technological collaboration and possible collaboration with International Oil Companies (IOCs) and National Oil Companies (NOCs), as OIL, which is one of the seven Maharatna public sector undertakings (PSUs), plans to counter the high geological and financial risks of offshore exploration.

Talking to ***Millennium Post*** on the sidelines of the 67th Annual General Meeting of OIL, the company's Chairman and Managing Director Ranjit Rath said OIL already has a technology service agreement with TotalEnergies for its offshore exploration efforts.

"We have a technology service agreement with TotalEnergies for all our offshore explorations. In addition to that, we are also looking for collaboration from IOCs/NOCs internationally in the upcoming bidding rounds for OLP-10 and OLP-11," Rath added.

The official further said that OIL is looking into some of the potential blocks where OIL could collaborate with IOCs and NOCs, and OIL is gearing up for the coming bidding rounds.

Oil India Ltd Chairman and MD Ranjit Rath

According to Rath, the success of OIL in exploration in the Andaman and Nicobar islands area has increased their confidence in taking up offshore activities. The company has proved that there is natural gas in two out of the three drilled wells."OIL has gained confidence from it, and these global partnerships will help us in our Samudrayaan initiative," said Rath.

The company will follow a phased approach for its offshore exploration where first a well will be drilled and then, depending on the outcome of the first well, another will be drilled.

Rs 15,000 crore capital provision for offshore exploration projects

According to Rath, OIL has made a capital provision of about Rs 15,000 crore for its offshore exploration plans. The company will get further insurance coverage from the offshore exploration plan launched by the government.

The offshore project can require investment of about Rs 1,300-1,500 crore, whereas government support can range up to Rs 675 crore.

"This will give us plenty of risk coverage, and it will happen on an annual basis. We can make plans about our capital expenditure in such a way that we are planning for a three-year capex," Rath said.

KEY POINTS

- The firm will get further insurance coverage from the offshore exploration plan launched by the govt
- In relation to Andaman, Rath said that OIL would carry out an appraisal program before making the decision for development
- There will be more emphasis on natural gas, with Rath forecasting gas production at about 5 BCM

Large-scale seismic surveys and parametric or stratigraphic wells can lower the risks of geology.

Andaman discovery set for appraisal

In relation to the Andaman discovery, Rath said that OIL would carry out an appraisal program before making the decision regarding development. There is already confirmation of the presence of hydrocarbons in the area, but the exact extent of the commerciality of the discovery is to be appraised.

"Exploration has to come first before the development of any infrastructure. After the evaluation and correlation of the discovery, infrastructure development will take place," he said.

As far as deep water and ultra deep water discoveries are concerned, OIL believes there will not be any problem with infrastructure.

Gas, clean energy to dominate

OIL will continue with both onshore and offshore exploration and development. It conducted drilling at 74 wells in the previous year, of which 22 were exploratory, and 52 were developmental, as well as 307 workover drilling operations. Its current oil production is estimated at 86,000 barrels per day.

There will be more emphasis on natural gas, with Rath forecasting gas production at about 5 BCM, while that of oil will be at more than 4 million tonnes. There will also be an increase in PNG and CNG usage in the Northeast and gas supply for industries and fertilisers.

In addition to hydrocarbon production, OIL is also making investments in solar and wind energy, compressed biogas, geothermal energy, and carbon sequestration. The latter will comprise compressed biogas plants that can process about 1,500 tonnes of municipal solid waste daily at four sites, among other initiatives.

Oil India goes deeper offshore, aims 10 MMTOE production by 2029

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, September 17

Oil India Limited (OIL) aims for an output of 10 million tonnes of oil equivalent (MMTOE) of oil and gas production by the end of the decade (2029), with the Maharatna public sector energy company ramping up its exploration efforts in new frontiers on both onshore and offshore assets, including deep and ultra-deep water blocks.

Speaking to media persons on the sidelines of the company's 67th Annual General Meeting held on Thursday, chairman and managing director Ranjit Rath stated that the growth plan of OIL will revolve around increasing domestic oil and gas production, ramping up its exploration efforts, enhancing its integrated energy offerings, and venturing into clean energy areas selectively.

OIL produced 3.450 million tonnes (MMT) of crude oil and 3.186 billion cubic meters (BCM) of natural gas in the fiscal year 2025-26.

Even though it has been operating in mostly mature fields, it has achieved a terminal crude oil production rate of 10,566 tons per day, the highest in 14 years, mainly due to increased efforts in drilling, workovers, and reservoir management.

It drilled 74 wells, of which 22 were exploratory and 52 were development.

OIL PRODUCED 3.450 MILLION TONNES (MMT) OF CRUDE OIL AND 3.186 BILLION CUBIC METERS (BCM) OF NATURAL GAS IN THE FISCAL YEAR 2025-26

The company's Reserve Replacement Ratio has increased to 1.02.

It has continued the production growth in the current financial year as well. In the first quarter of FY27, crude oil production was up by 11 per cent from last year at 0.950 MMT while the company reached an all-time high daily crude production of 10,921 tonnes, which is equal to 84,109 barrels. The company's financial performance has been robust, with consolidated profit after tax being Rs 7,551 crore in FY26 and the consolidated net worth being Rs 53,716 crore. OIL paid out a total dividend of Rs 11.50 per equity share in the year.

For instance, the OIL Group made investments totalling more than Rs 21,673 crore during the financial year FY26 in exploration and production, refining, pipelines, and strategic growth projects. Furthermore, an important part of the OIL Company's future growth plans involves increasing its offshore exploration portfolio. With its exploration portfolio spread over more than one lakh square kilometres, the firm has interests in many onshore and offshore sedimentary basins.

The OIL Company's offshore exploration portfolio presently covers acreage in the Andaman, Krishna-Godavari, Mahanadi, and Kerala-Konkan basins as well as ultra-deepwater blocks. The company is aiming at developing skills for frontier offshore exploration due to the fact that India seeks to increase its domestic hydrocarbon resource base. The Samudra Manthan scheme is likely to facilitate this process.

Apart from hydrocarbons, OIL is also seeking growth in new energy technologies. The MC² platform is a PSU-driven initiative where the firm is helping in developing new energy technologies and capability for energy transition.

Rath said OIL will keep its focus on growing production of domestic crude oil and natural gas, exploration, frontier offshore capability and new energy business while being capital prudent and keeping a balanced balance sheet.

As per the company, its overall strategy still aligns with making India energy secure and self-reliant, while creating shareholder value in the process towards achieving Viksit Bharat 2047.

NSE's ₹22,569 cr IPO subscribed 43% on Day 1

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 17

The mega Rs 22,569-crore initial public offering of the NSE opened for subscription on Thursday, with the issue getting subscribed 43 per cent on the first day of bidding. The offering is India's second-largest public issue after Hyundai Motor India's Rs 27,870-crore IPO in 2024.

The NSE IPO received bids for 3.83 crore shares against 8.86 crore shares on offer, as per data available with the exchanges.

The category for non-institutional investors was subscribed 72 per cent & the retail portion was booked 44 per cent. The quota for Qualified Institutional Buyers garnered 19 per cent subscription.

The NSE on Wednesday raised Rs 6,746 crore from anchor investors, including state-owned LIC, Goldman Sachs and Fidelity.

Additionally, sovereign wealth funds GIC Singapore, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) and Norges Bank, as well as Eastspring and HSBC Global Asset Management also participated in the anchor round.

Govt puts 25 coal blocks on sale in 16th round of auctions

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 17

The Coal Ministry on Thursday launched the 16th round of commercial coal mine auctions, offering 25 blocks across eight states, including Odisha, Maharashtra, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh.

Of these, 21 mines are fully explored and four partially explored. Minister of State for Coal and Mines Satish Chandra Dubey invited investors to participate, saying the auction could generate employment and attract investments.

The ministry also handed over Coal Mine Development and Production Agreements to successful bidders of six mines auctioned earlier.

The six mines have combined geological reserves of about 1,504 million tonnes and peak rated capacity of 11.62 MTPA. They are expected to generate annual revenue of Rs 1,984 crore, attract Rs 1,743 crore investment and create around 15,700 jobs.

Since commercial coal mining began in 2020, 147 mines have been auctioned across 15 rounds, bringing 44 new companies into the sector.

Coal production from captive and commercial mines reached 210.46 MT in FY26, up 10.22 per cent year-on-year.

IndiGo raises charges for several ancillary services

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 17

IndiGo has revised charges for several ancillary services, increasing fees for infant travel, excess baggage, unaccompanied minors, priority check-in and boarding, and travel certificates, according to media reports.

The infant travel fee has been raised to Rs 3,000 from Rs 2,000 for children aged three days to two years.

Infants do not get a separate seat but require a ticket.

The airline has increased its unaccompanied minor service fee on domestic flights to Rs 5,999 from Rs 5,000, while the international charge is Rs 12,999.

Domestic excess baggage charges have risen to Rs 800 per kg from Rs 700.

INFANT TRAVEL FEE HAS BEEN HIKED TO RS 3,000 FROM RS 2,000 FOR CHILDREN AGED 3 DAYS TO TWO YEARS

A passenger carrying five kg of excess baggage will now pay Rs 4,000, compared with Rs 3,500 earlier.

IndiGo's Fast Forward service, offering priority check-in and boarding, now costs Rs 650 at domestic airports, up from Rs 450, while the charge for international flights has been revised to Rs 850 per sector.

The travel certificate fee has also increased to Rs 300 from Rs 200. The certificate serves as proof of travel for reimbursement, GST and leave travel concession claims.

The revised charges cover optional services purchased in addition to the base airfare and apply across applicable domestic and international services.

NMDC co-hosts CVC training programme for vigilance officers of organisations in South Zone

MPOST BUREAU
Hyderabad, September 17

The Vigilance Department of NMDC Limited co-hosted a Central Vigilance Commission (CVC) Training of Trainers Programme in Hyderabad on Thursday on "Master Circulars and Vigilance Manual 2026" for vigilance officers of organisations in the South Zone.

Chief Guest Praveen Kumar Sinha, Former Special Director, CBI, addressed the programme virtually and highlighted the significance of the CVC Master Circulars, revision of the Vigilance Manual and rotation of personnel in sensitive posts as a preventive vigilance measure.

CVC Consultant Rajiv Verma, Director AjaiKumar Verma and OSD Arvind Kumar also attended, along with CVOs Spurthi Reddy (MIDHANI & BDL), P. Krishna Kumar (ECIL) and C. Neelakanta Reddy (NMDC).

CVC speakers explained key changes in the Vigilance Manual 2026 and provisions of recently issued Master Circulars, addressing participants' queries.

Around 75 vigilance officers and representatives participated. The programme focused on knowledge sharing, capacity building and strengthening vigilance practices.

From khadi to AI: India-UK students redefine design across borders

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 17

Education in design is becoming more about going beyond classrooms and geographical limitations, with Indian & UK students working remotely to produce cross-cultural designs that combine traditional art forms and new technologies and design techniques.

The one-year academic exchange program between Pearl Academy and four higher education institutes in the UK has led to Design Without Borders: Creative Futures Collective, which is an exhibition at the British Council in New Delhi.

The collaboration, sponsored by the British Council, has enabled the participation of students from Pearl Academy, Manchester Metropolitan University, Nottingham Trent University, London College of Contemporary Arts and Birmingham City University.

India secures 1.9 million tonne steel quota from EU

With this, India has secured over 80 per cent of its exports to the European Union

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 17

India has received a country-specific tariff-rate quota of 1.9 million tonne (MT) annually for steel exports to the European Union, while the government expects exporters to secure another 0.9 MT through residual quotas, taking the total to 2.8 MT, a commerce ministry official said on Thursday.

With this, India has secured over 80 per cent of its exports to the European Union. Last fiscal, India exported about 3 MT of steel goods.

The Tariff-Rate Quota (TRQ) follows the EU's Steel Overcapacity Regulation, which came into force on July 1. It provides 18.3 MT of duty-free quotas, with a 50 per cent duty on imports beyond the quota and a melt-and-pour regime to improve transparency.

Indian exporters have already started using the quota, with shipments within the quota attracting zero duty. The official said FTA benefits for the steel sector had been frontloaded and first-quarter exports of 2026-27 had already been completed.

CLOSER LOOK

- The Tariff-Rate Quota (TRQ) follows the EU's Steel Overcapacity Regulation, which came into force on July 1
- It provides 18.3 MT of duty-free quotas, with a 50 per cent duty on imports beyond the quota and a melt-and-pour regime to improve transparency

The quota covers non-alloy and alloy hot-rolled sheets and strips, cold-rolled sheets, coated steel, stainless steel, merchant bars, rebars, wire rods, pipes and tubes.

For categories without a country-specific quota, India will have access to residual quotas, including general residual quotas and preferential quotas for EU FTA partners. The quota in the FTA text was 1.6 MT, but negotiations between February and June secured an additional 0.3 MT. India accounts for about 10 per cent of the EU's total steel imports.

However, the EU's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) will apply to Indian steel both within and outside the quota. GTRI estimates the carbon charge could average about 35 per cent when fully phased in.

The government is helping exporters comply with CBAM, with six Indian institutes applying for recognition as accreditation bodies for CBAM verifiers. It is seeking faster approval and is looking at 10 such institutions.

The EU has announced Euro 500 million over the next two years for technical and financial assistance and capacity building.

India is also working to increase FTA utilisation and address non-tariff barriers.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE

The 'Swachhata Hi Seva Campaign-2026' was launched at Rail Coach Factory (RCF), Kapurthala, on Thursday. The theme is 'Swachhata Mein Sahbhag – Swachh Bharat, Viksit Bharat'. The campaign runs from September 17 to October 15, 2026. The General Manager Ajay Nandan administered the Swachhata pledge to officers and employees.

'CHIP DESIGN WOULD BE 1ST OF THE 6 PILLARS OF SEMICON 2.0'

Govt to aim 200 chip design startups, firms under Semicon 2.0: Vaishnaw

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 17

The government will target at least 200 startups and companies designing chips in India under the next phase of the country's semiconductor mission, Semicon 2.0, Union Minister for Electronics & IT Ashwini Vaishnaw said on Thursday.

Addressing the inaugural session of SEMICON India 2026, Vaishnaw noted chip design would be the first of six pillars of Semicon 2.0, with the government scaling up ambitions after the previous phase of the mission saw more than 105 startups attempted chip design, of which about 20 secured venture capital funding worth around Rs 800 crore.

"That was just the beginning. This time our ambition is much bigger. We would be targeting at least 200 startups and companies which design chips in India across the spectrum of semiconductor requirements," he said. The minister said the country had built the foundational base for a domestic semiconductor industry over the past few years through Semicon 1.0, a calibrated programme focused on nurturing talent and building the ecosystem.

THE SECOND PILLAR, MACHINES & MATERIALS, WOULD COVER THE ENTIRE ECOSYSTEM OF CAPITAL EQUIPMENT, MAINTENANCE FACILITIES, CHEMICALS & GASES, VAISHNAW SAID

"Now, we have to build the building over this foundation," Vaishnaw said, outlining the contours of the next phase of the mission and its six pillars: design, machines and materials, fabrication units, advanced packaging, research and development, and talent.

KEY POINTS

- The 3rd pillar will focus on setting up more display, memory, silicon, compound and logic fabrication units, Vaishnaw said
- The 4th pillar involves scaling up advanced packaging units, building on an existing 3D packaging facility coming up in Odisha, he said
- 'The fifth pillar, research and development, will take up industry-driven, applied R&D projects in collaboration with academia'
- 'On 6th pillar — talent — against target of 85K design engineers over 10 yrs, govt had already trained 70K design engineers in 4 years'

The second pillar, machines and materials, would cover the entire ecosystem of capital equipment, maintenance facilities, chemicals and gases, Vaishnaw said, noting participation from more than 28 countries at the conference. Recalling guidance from the prime minister five years ago at the start of the programme, Vaishnaw said, "Don't think short term, think long term. Don't think fab, think ecosystem," adding that this philosophy had continued to shape the mission's design.

The third pillar will focus on setting up more display, memory, silicon, compound and logic fabrication units, which Vaishnaw said would have a multiplier effect on the ecosystem.

The fourth pillar involves scaling up advanced packaging units, building on an existing 3D packaging facility coming up in Odisha, he said. "We would like to have much more progress in the advanced packaging because that is a very important part of the entire value chain."

The fifth pillar, R&D, will take up industry-driven, applied R&D projects in collaboration with academia, Vaishnaw said, inviting industry participants to suggest projects for this collaborative approach.

On the sixth pillar – talent – Vaishnaw said that against a target of training 85,000 design engineers over 10 years under Semicon 1.0, the government had already trained 70,000 design engineers in just four years.

He said more than 400 universities across the country now have access to the world's latest Electronic Design Automation (EDA) tools from companies such as Cadence, Siemens and Synopsys, with the Semiconductor Laboratory in Mohali being used for taping out student-designed chips.

Under Semicon 2.0, the government will additionally target developing 1 lakh skilled technicians, cleanroom personnel and factory floor talent for direct employment in upcoming semiconductor factories in India, creating a global pool of talent.

Vaishnaw described the semicon mission as a long journey, saying the foundation built so far would pave the way toward India's goal of becoming a developed nation, or Viksit Bharat, by 2047.

FinMin sees no increase in cash transactions post UPI MDR levy

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 17

The Finance Ministry does not expect an increase in cash transactions due to the levy of 0.4 per cent Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) for UPI transactions above Rs 2,000, which comes into effect from October 15, sources said on Thursday.

Sources said it is anticipated that the imposition of MDR would not lead to a reduction in UPI transactions as only 4 per cent of total volume is getting impacted due to the decision.

Asked about the concerns leading to an increase in cash transactions post October 15, sources said it is unlikely to happen as transactions through RuPay debit cards are completely free regardless of amount.

The ministry is also preparing to put a monitoring mechanism in place to ensure that the UPI MDR burden is not passed on to customers, sources added, assuaging widespread concerns of transfer of MDR charges to end users.

The ministry has already initiated discussions with payment aggregators and other stakeholders in the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) ecosystem to sensitise them about the MDR and ensure that the burden is not passed on to consumers, sources said.

IT IS UNLIKELY TO HAPPEN AS TRANSACTIONS THROUGH RUPAY DEBIT CARDS ARE COMPLETELY FREE REGARDLESS OF AMOUNT

On concerns that the levy could lead to an increase in prices of goods and services, the sources said the measure is unlikely to have an inflationary impact.

The sources also said the Goods and Services Tax (GST) applicable on MDR will be largely offset through input tax credit and, therefore, its impact on the overall cost is expected to be limited.

Various transactions have been put under specialised categories, the sources said, adding that the ministry does not anticipate any significant impact of GST on MDR.

However, if any issues relating to GST on MDR remain unresolved, they could be taken up for consideration by the GST Council at its meeting, the sources added.

The introduction of a 0.4 per cent MDR on certain UPI transactions above Rs 2,000 is aimed at creating a sustainable revenue framework for the digital payments ecosystem.

The MDR is a fee paid by merchants to payment service providers for processing digital transactions.

From October 15, a 0.4 per cent MDR will apply to person-to-merchant UPI payments above Rs 2,000. The charge will be paid by merchants, not consumers, and will be capped at Rs 300 for transactions of Rs 75,000 or more. Payments between individuals, as well as the vast majority of everyday merchant payments, will remain free.

Essential services, such as railways, telecom, fuel and insurance, will attract a flat Rs 5 fee per transaction above Rs 2,000. Capital markets transactions (mutual funds, stockbroking) get a lower 0.02 per cent rate, also capped at Rs 300.

Small merchants collecting up to Rs 1 lakh a month via UPI QR codes remain fully exempt from any new charge - a carve-out, officials say, shields about 96 per cent of all merchant transactions.

Briefs

Rupee rises 2 paise to 95.89 against dollar

NEW DELHI: The rupee staged a spirited recovery after slipping below the 96 level intraday and settled higher by 2 paise at 95.89 against the US dollar on Thursday.

At the interbank forex market, the rupee opened at 95.88 & traded in range of 96.10-95.78 before settling at 95.89 against dollar, up 2 paise from the previous closing level.

BharatPe backs MDR framework

NEW DELHI: BharatPe on Thursday backed the new MDR framework for UPI merchant transactions & distanced itself from former co-founder Ashneer Grover's remarks.

BharatPe said Grover has had no association with the company since 2024 and is not associated with it in any capacity. BharatPe CEO Nalin Negi said the framework will keep UPI free for consumers while protecting micro and small merchants through zero MDR.

Semicon 2.0: Govt bars chip plant sales before commercial production

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 17

New chip plants approved under the Semicon 2.0 programme cannot sell, dispose of or mortgage project assets until commercial production of the entire project is declared, according to guidelines issued on Thursday.

Any sale, disposal or creation of mortgage, lien or charge on project assets will require prior approval of the Nodal Agency, except in the ordinary course of business. Units receiving fiscal support must remain in commercial production for at least three years from the commencement of commercial production of the entire project.

Semicon 2.0 has six pillars – semiconductor design, machines and materials, setting up more fabs, strengthening ATMP and OSAT industries, research and development, and talent development. Guidelines have been issued for machines and materials, fabs and ATMP and OSAT.

Applicants under the machines and materials pillar can also receive PLI benefits for domestically sourced components and sub-assemblies. Expenditure on land development, temporary facilities, tech-transfer, interest during construction & R&D will not qualify as eligible capex.

Applicant & promoter or group applying for the incentive under the scheme should hold at least 51 per cent of the total equity share capital with equivalent voting rights in the project company at all times during the term of the fiscal support agreement (FSA), including its three years of operation after the commercial operation date.

The controlling entity must be identified at the application stage itself, and its continuity is a condition for continued fiscal support and fulfilment of other conditions as per the FSA. Any change in shareholding must be reported to the Nodal Agency during this period, the guidelines said.

Benchmark Sensex & Nifty close nearly flat after US Federal Reserve's interest rate hike

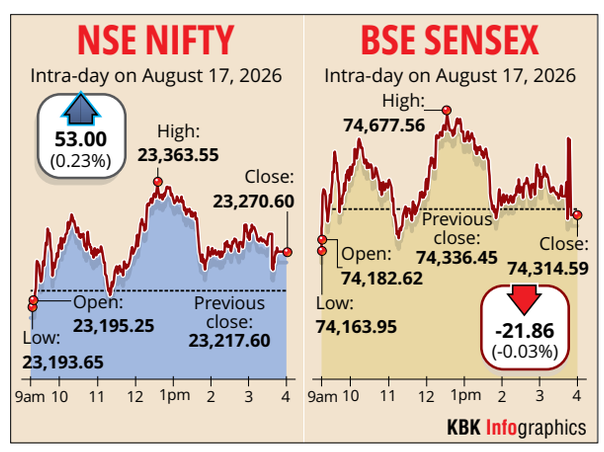
PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, September 17

Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty closed nearly flat on Thursday as caution prevailed after the US Federal Reserve increased its interest rates and indicated further tightening in monetary policy.

Giving up intraday gains, the 30-share BSE Sensex dipped 21.86 points, or 0.03 per cent, to settle at 74,314.59.

The 50-share NSE Nifty closed higher by 53 points, or 0.23 per cent, at 23,270.60.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, HDFC Bank, Titan, ICICI Bank, State Bank of India, Bharti Airtel and Axis Bank were the major laggards.



Tata Steel, Bharat Electronics, InterGlobe Aviation, Eternal, Maruti and Asian Paints were among the gainers.

Broader markets closed higher as the BSE SmallCap Select index jumped 0.95 per cent and the MidCap Select index climbed 0.72 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Insurance surged the most by 3.23 per cent, Capital Goods 1.96 per cent, Industrials 1.51 per cent, Realty 1.47 per cent, Healthcare 1.36 per cent, Hospitals 1.35 per cent, Services 1.33 per cent, Metal 1.12 per cent, and Auto 1.11 per cent.

Top 10 Banks declined 0.72 per cent, Private Banks index 0.63 per cent, Bankex 0.50 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt 0.35 per cent, Energy 0.35 per cent, Oil & Gas 0.25 per cent, Housing Finance 0.21 per cent and MidSmall Private Banks 0.19 per cent.

FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 2,032.61 crore on Wednesday, according to exchange data.

NaBFID hosts Infrastructure Conclave 2026

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, September 17

The National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaBFID) hosted the Infrastructure Conclave 2026 in Mumbai, bringing together stakeholders to discuss strengthening infrastructure financing & mobilising domestic and global long-term capital.

SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey and Laya Madduri, IAS, Joint Secretary, Infrastructure Finance Secretariat, Department of Economic Affairs, delivered keynote addresses.

The conclave also saw the launch of two research reports – "Channelizing Domestic and Global Capital for Infrastructure Financing" and "Catalysing India's Economic Ambitions through Bond Market Development."

Panel discussions covered bridging the infrastructure financing gap, mobilising insurance capital, structured finance solutions, asset monetisation by states and emerging sources of infrastructure capital. Discussions also examined securitisation, Credit Default Swaps, Total Return Swaps, InvITs and REITs, along with private credit, infrastructure funds, pension funds, sovereign wealth funds and insurance capital.

Rajkiran Rai G., Managing Director, NaBFID, said, "India's infrastructure ambitions require a strong and diversified financing ecosystem that can effectively channel long-term domestic and global capital." The conclave aimed to foster collaboration and identify avenues to deepen capital markets and strengthen India's infrastructure financing architecture.

Small merchants, P2P transactions to remain free on UPI: ASSOCHAM

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 17

More than 3 crore micro units with monthly UPI turnover below Rs 1 lakh will not face merchant discount rate (MDR) charges, ASSOCHAM said, welcoming the new framework for large-value merchant transactions.

All person-to-person (P2P) UPI transactions will remain free, irrespective of the amount, while merchant payments up to Rs 2,000 will also attract no MDR. Around 96 per cent of merchant transactions will remain unaffected, with MDR applying to about 4 per cent of P2M transactions.

Nirmal K Minda, President, ASSOCHAM

For specified merchant transactions above Rs 2,000, MDR will be 0.4 per cent, capped at Rs 300 for transactions of Rs 75,000 and above. Essential sectors will attract a flat Rs 5 MDR.

Nirmal K Minda, President, ASSOCHAM, said, "By creating a sustainable revenue mechanism while protecting consumers and small merchants, the framework can support greater investment in innovation, infrastructure and payment acceptance. This will further strengthen UPI's role in driving India's digital transformation."

NSE facilitates ₹1,000 crore tokenised bond issuances by REC and L&T

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, September 17

The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) has successfully implemented tokenisation technology for corporate bonds on its Electronic Bidding Platform (NSE EBP) under the SEBI Regulatory Sandbox Framework, enabling India's first tokenised bond issuances by REC Ltd and Larsen & Toubro Ltd, cumulatively raising Rs 1,000 Crore.

The technology was unveiled on September 10, 2026 by RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra and SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey at the Global Fintech Fest 2026 in Mumbai.

REC's issuance had a base issue of Rs 100 crore and a green shoe option of Rs 400 crore. It received 7.9x subscription to the base issue, with REC accepting Rs 500 Crore at a 7.30 per cent coupon rate.

This was followed by L&T's Rs 500 crore tokenised corporate bond issuance, demonstrating its application by a private-sector issuer.

Tokenisation uses Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) to digitally represent and manage securities, facilitating atomic settlement, greater transparency and operational efficiency.

NSE Executive Director Viral Mody said the issuances mark an important milestone in translating emerging technologies into scalable solutions for regulated market infrastructure. He also acknowledged the guidance and support of SEBI and RBI in enabling responsible innovation.

Trust is foundation of every healthy economy: Kovind

Kovind calls anti-counterfeiting fight a battle for institutional trust

AAISHA SABIR
New Delhi, September 17

A FICCI-KPMG report on illicit trade in India has flagged the economic drain and governance challenges posed by smuggling & counterfeiting, with speakers at the FICCI-CASCADE 'MASCRADE 2026' conference on Thursday highlighting how such networks exploit legitimate supply chains and digital platforms to evade detection.

Chairman of the CBIC, Vivek Chaturvedi, noted that illicit networks now operate through "entire parallel supply chains using legitimate logistics infrastructure, documentation and financial channels" to disguise their activity. He cited the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence's 3,000 commercial cases in FY 2024-25, involving roughly Rs 4,000 crore in duty and incentive amounts.

The report, released at the Movement Against Smuggled and Counterfeit Trade conference, underscores that illicit trade networks which are now "increasingly sophisticated, technology-enabled & borderless," with impact extending beyond revenue losses to undermine investment, employment, consumer safety & fair competition, said Anant Swarup, Secretary General, FICCI.

Former President Ram Nath Kovind, characterised the fight against counterfeiting as a battle to protect institutional trust. "Trust is the invisible foundation of every healthy economy. Smuggling & counterfeiting gradually erode that trust," he said, adding that the entire economic system rests on faith between consumers & manufacturers and between investors & regulators.

Outlining a collaborative framework, Chairman, FICCI CASCADE, Anil Rajput, called for unified intelligence, networked enforcement, innovation & citizen empowerment to combat what he termed a "security imperative" for nations worldwide.

CHESS OLYMPIAD

India beat Indonesia

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Samarkand, September 17

Defending champions in both the open and women's events, the Indian teams won their matches -- albeit with some hiccups -- to remain atop the leaderboard with four match points after the second round of the 46th Chess Olympiad here on Thursday.

For the second day running, Nihal Sarin was the difference between two teams as he defeated Hafiz Arif Abdul after briefly missing out on a tactical trick. Up against a Sicilian with white pieces, Nihal went for a direct attack against the black king but for just one move his own king came under serious trouble.

However, as it happened, Hafiz missed on the trick and landed his king in deep trouble with many pieces still remaining on the board. Nihal wrapped up the issues quickly thereafter.

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि हमके, सुखी राम पुत्र कारे सिंह व किशन प्यारी पत्नी श्री सुखी राम निवसीगण देहलाका, (8) पलवल, हरियाणा–121102 ने अपने पुत्र रामेश्वर को इसके अभद्र व्यवहार व आये दिन हमारे साथ लडाई झगडा करना व हमारी कोई सेवा, सहायता न करना व हमारे कहे अनुसार न चलने के कारण हमनें अपने पुत्र रामेश्वर को अपनी तमाम चल व अचल सम्पत्ति से बेदखल कर दिया है। भविष्य में जो कोई भी व्यक्ति इससे किसी भी प्रकार का लेनदेन व रिश्ता रखता है तो उसका जिम्मेवार वह स्वयं होगा। हमारी व हमारे परिवार के अन्य सदस्य की कोई जिम्मेवारी नहीं होगी।

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
GREATER MOHALI AREA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
PUDA Bhawan, Sector 62, SAS Nagar
Tender Notice No. GMADA/D.E (PH-2)/2026/2022-2031
Dated 17-09-2026

Divisional Engineer (PH-2), GMADA, SAS Nagar invites online bids for **"Engagement of consultant for preparation of design, drawing, DPR, Tender documentation and proof checking for the up-gradation of Kajauli Pump House, Construction of WTP Phase-2 at Sinpur, and laying of rising main at SAS Nagar."**

Closing date & time: **05-10-2026 at 11:00 AM**
For details log onto: **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
Note: Any corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.
RO No PR-Advt. No :-1324/12/2026-27/15307

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

Name of work	Repair and raising of boundary wall with concertina fencing from the entry gate of Anand Vihar railway Terminal to the washing line complex for ensuring safety of staff and passengers and preventing trespassing at ANVT in the section of SSE/Works/ANVT under ADEN/NDLS.
Approx cost of work	Rs. 1,74,89,464.64/- (Rupees One Crore Seventy Four Lakh Eighty Nine Thousand Four Hundred Sixty Four and Sixty Four Paise Only)
Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 3,49,800.00/- (Rupees Three Lakh Forty Nine Thousand Eight Hundred Only)
Cost of tender document	Rs. 0.00/-
Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender.	09.10.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen.	**www.ireps.gov.in**

- The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for participating in the e-tender system.
- For all terms and conditions please refer tender document.
- No manual offers are acceptable.
- Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway.

No.: 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/43/2026-27/W-3 Dated: 16.09.2026 3220/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of work and its location	112-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27 Provision of 48 V pit light and catwalk light with other allied works in washing cum pit line (03 Nos.) at Old Delhi Station.
Approx. cost of the works in	Rs. 10445600.00/-
Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055
Earnest Money	Rs. 208900.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	09/10/2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender	09/10/2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board	**www.ireps.gov.in** & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3222/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
Invitation of tender through
E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

The Divisional Engineer-IV, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.

1	**Name of work with its location**	1. Left over Work & Deficiencies in Railway Qtrs. on PPDE-SNP Branch line under ADEN/Jind. (NIT 42/26-27-W-IV)
2	**Approx. cost of work.**	(1) Rs. 2,34,37,384.29
3	**Earnest money**	(1) Rs 4,68,800.00
4	**Date and Time of submission of tender and opening of tender**	Bidding Start date for work no. Up to 15:00 hrs. On 25.09.2026 opening of e-Tender at 15:00 hrs. on 09.10.2026
5	**Website particulars, published e-tender, notice location etc, complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded**	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No. 128-W/260/Tender Notice/ 42/26-27/W-IV Date: 17.09.2026 3230/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Kapil Sangwan @ Nandu, S/o Late Surajbhan R/o RZ-78, Nanda Enclave, Najafgarh, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.72/26 dated 20.03.2026 u/s 308(2)/125/61(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita & 25 Arms Act, P.S. Special Cell, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kapil Sangwan @ Nandu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kapil Sangwan @ Nandu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Kapil Sangwan @ Nandu** of **FIR No.72/26 dated 20.03.2026 u/s 308(2)/125/61(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita & 25 Arms Act, P.S. Special Cell, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.11.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Mridul Gupta
Chief Judicial Magistrate, 26, G.F., Annexe Building
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi
DP/13109/Spl.Cell/2026

PHYSICAL POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Home Finance Registered Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai- 400051
Corporate Office: ICICI HFC Tower, JB Nagar, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400059
Branch Office: 1st Floor, SCO No. 89, Sector-16, Shopping Center Of Urban Estate, Faridabad- 121002
Branch Office: A-354, Sector-19, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301

Whereas
The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.
As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited.
The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Loan Account Number	Description of property/ Date of Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Preeti Kumari (Borrower), Rajesh Kumar (Co-Borrower), NHFDB00001275938	Flat No. 1302, on 13th Floor, Block-C, Builind Named As "Sunshine Helios" Plot No. Gh 05B, Sector 78 Tower, Noida, Uttar Pradesh- 201301, Total Super Area 1685 Sq. Ft. With Covered Parking(one). Bounded By- East : Open, West : Flat No. 1303, North : Flat No. 1301, South : Open./ Date of Possession-15-Sep-2026	17-06-2025 Rs. 65,11,105.92/-	Faridabad
2.	Shivam (Borrower), Kamlesh Rani (Co-Borrower), 182 NDMC Housing Complex Rohini Sector 11 New Delhi Delhi- 110085 Delhi, LHNOD00001522990	Plot No. 64, Khasra No. 773mi, Situated At Shri Ram City-2, Village Bisrakh Jalalpur, Pargana and Tahsil Dadri, Distrct Gautam Buddh Nagar- 201306 Uttar Pradesh, Area 131 Sq. Yds. Out Of Total Area 150 Sq. Yds. Bounded By- North By : Pvt./road 14 Ft, South By : Other Property, East By : Entry/rasta 22 Ft, West By : Other Property./ Date of Possession-14-Sep-2026	11-06-2026 Rs. 24,74,941/-	Noida

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/ guarantors(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the expiry of 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under the Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.
Date : September 18, 2026, Place: Noida Authorized Officer, ICICI Home Finance Company Limited

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida-201301 (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited for the following job from eligible bidders who are registered on Prahari Software, these may be uploaded by the dates specified below, and the received E-tenders will be opened on the dates indicated against them. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **https://etender.up.nic.in**. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) Fresh-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1.	04/GM(Civil)/SM (E/M-III)/2026-27	Comprehensive Annual Maintenance For EPABX Telephone System installed & CCTV at Command Control Centre Building Near Mahamaya Flyover Sector-94 Noida	15.20
2.	10/GM(Civil)/SM (E/M-III)/2026-27	Shifting of CCTV Camera Pole and cables for proposed underpass on Noida to Greater Noida Express way, Noida	9.90
3.	55/SM(WC-4)/ET/ 2026-27	Emergency work (Dewatering at different Location in Work Circle-4 area), Noida.	21.12
4.	11/GM/SM(WC-3)/ 2026-27	D/o Sector (Reconstruction of Boundary wall Sector-48), Noida.	25.44

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 18.09.2026 to 05.10.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 06.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.

B) Re-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
5.	06/GM/SM(WC-1)/ 2026-27	P/L Thermoplastic Paint on Udyog Marg Sector-14A Flyover to Sector-11, T-Point, Noida.	29.50
6.	36/GM/SM(WC-1)/ 2026-27	M/o Road (Beautification & Painting of Rajnigandha Underpass and P/F Polycarbonate sheets at Shahdara drain on MP-1 road, Noida.	27.09
7.	26/GM/SM(NTC)/ 2025-26	P/L Thermoplastic Paint and road Safety work on road between Sector-55 and 56, Noida.	7.30

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 18.09.2026 to 24.09.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 25.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (Civil)
NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)
Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts
Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.
Website : https://auction.arcil.co.in; **CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884**

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagor (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts **("ARCIL")** (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e-auction, for recovery of outstanding dues together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrower/s / Guarantor/s / Mortgager/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding Amount as per SARFAESI Notice Dated 20.11.2018	Possession Type and Date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
Borrower : 1. BALA 2. RAM WATI @ RAM BATI	Loan Account No. HHLNOD00316023 Edelweiss Asset Reconstruction Company Ltd. ("EARC")	Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust	Rs. 17,43,985/- (Rupees Seventeen Lakh Forty Three Thousand Nine Hundred Eighty Five only) as on 19.11.2018 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 02.04.2026	Will be arranged on request	Freehold - 550 Sq. ft. (covered area)	Rs. 1,39,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Thirty Nine Thousand only)	Rs. 13,90,000/- (Rupees Thirteen Lakh Ninety Thousand only)	On 19.10.2026 at 02:15 P.M.

Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned :
FLAT NO. UGF 2 (M. I. G.), HAVING A TOTAL COVERED AREA OF 550 SQ. FEET APPROXIMATELY EQUAL TO 51.09 SQ. MTR. ON UPPER GROUND FLOOR WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, FRONT RIGHT HAND SIDE, SITUATED ON PLOT NO. B5/12, DLF ANKUR VIHAR, LONI, GHAZIABAD - 201102, UTTAR PRADESH. THE SAID FLAT IS BOUNDED AS FOLLOWS :
EAST : COMMON PASSAGE; WEST : ROAD B - 5, 9 MTR. BROAD ROAD; NORTH : FLAT NO. UGF 1 (L. I. G.); SOUTH : PLOT NO. B - 5/13.

Pending Litigations known to ARCIL	**Nil**	**Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL**	**Nil**
Last Date for submission of Bid	**Same day 2 hours before Auction**	**Bid Increment amount :**	**As mentioned in the BID document**
Demand Draft to be made in name of :	**ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST**	**Payable at par**	
RTGS details	**ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST, Trust Account No. – 57500001353101, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamala Mill, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.**		
Name of Contact person & number	**Sanjeev Godara – 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).**		

Terms and Conditions :
1. The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website https://auction.arcil.co.in and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein.
2. The Authorised Officer ("AO") / ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc.
3. At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice.
4. The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law.
5. The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues.
6. The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission.
7. The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgagors, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale.
8. In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.

Place : GHAZIABAD **Sd/-**
Date : 09.09.2026 **Authorized Officer**
Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Trustee of Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust)

PUBLIC NOTICE

BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha (Bochasanwasi Shri Akshar Purushottam Swaminarayan Sanstha) is pleased to inform that the project titled "Expansion of the Cultural Complex-Akshardham" at NH-24, Pramukh Swami Maharaj Marg, Akshardham Setu, New Delhi has been accorded Environmental Clearance vide Identification No. EC26C3803DL5108727N dated 10/09/2026 from the State Environment Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA), Delhi.

Copies of the Environmental Clearance letter are available with the SEIAA and can also be seen on their website **http://environmentclearance.nic.in.**

BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha (Bochasanwasi Shri Akshar Purushottam Swaminarayan Sanstha)

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.
Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Jitender Singh Malik/ Shamsher Singh/ Sudesh Kumari/ LBROH00005704578	Flat No D 206, 2nd Floor Rof Alante Tower D, Village Dharampur, Sector 108, Gurgaon, Haryana- 122003, September 16, 2026	November 27, 2025 Rs. 22,35,168.54/-	Gurgaon (Haryana)
2.	Aashirwad Gaur (Through Its Legal Heir)/ Mohinder Gaur/ LBDEL00005208632	Apartment No 220, Tower No J, 2nd Floor, The Room, Central Park Flower Valley, Villages Dhunela & Berka Sector 29, 30 & 32, Tehsil Sohna Gurgaon- 122001, September 16, 2026	March 30,2026 Rs. 69,29,219.81/-	Gurgaon (Haryana)

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: September 18, 2026
Place: Gurgaon (Haryana)
Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

HIMACHAL PRADESH
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer HPPWD Division Hamirpur Distt. Hamirpur H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the item rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed in the table.

Sr. No	Name of work	Estimated cost (Rs.)	Starting Date for downloding Bid	EMD (Rs.)	Deadline for Submission of Bid	Time limit
1	C/O Utility Duct in Hamirpur Town. (Phase-I) From D.C. Office Chowk to BhotaChowk via Main Bazaar (Sub Head :- C/O Main Duct including the infrastructure of HPSEB & JSV).	29,70,66,806/-	21-09-2026	39,70,700/-	28-09-2026	Six Month

The bidders are advised to note othr details of tenders from the department website **www.hptenders.gov.in.**
Executive Engineer, Hamirpur Division,
HPPWD, Hamirpur. Pin Code 177001
Telephone No. 01972-222510
e-mail: ee-ham-hp@nic.in
Ro. No. 3458/2026-2027 On behalf of Governor of Himachal pradesh

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA.
Public Works Department.
Executive Engineer, Publice Works (North) Divison, Jalgaon-425001
Phone No. 0257-2239408 / email-northjalgaon.ee@mahapwd.gov.in
E-Tender Notice No.13 For-2026-27 (Recall)
(Maharashtra Government, Public Works Department, Mantralaya Mumbai GR.Kr./Misc-2022/Pra.Kra.104/Building-2 Date.14/02/2025 According to Short Tender Notice)

Online Tenders (e-tender) in "B-1" form for **04 (Four) Bridge and Road Works** are invited by the Executive Engineer, P.W. (North) Division, Jalgaon for and behalf of Government of Maharashtra. Electonic Tender Management System. http://mahatenders.gov.in from Reputed and experienced firms / Contractors who fulfil the terms and condition of tender and having experience of similar type of work. The rights are reserve to reject all or any tender by Superitending Engineer/ Executive Engineer. Conditional tenders are not acceptable.

The details can be viewed and downloaded online from **18/09/2026 to 25/09/2026 at 17.00 Hrs.** directly from the Government of Maharashtra e-tendering Protal http://mahatenders.gov.in and **Pre-bid meeting** for will be held on **dated 21/09/2026 at 12.00 Hrs.** in the Office of Chief Engineer, P.W. Region, Nashik. This detailed tender notice is available on portal http://mahatenders.gov.in, also available on Notice Board of the Office of Executive Engineer, Public Works (North) Division, Jalgaon. Addendum / Corrigendum, if required, will be available only in the website.

(M.P.Patil)
Executive Engineer,
Public Works (North) Division,
Jalgaon.
DGIPR/2026/27/2875

HIMACHAL PRADESH
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
CORRIGENDUM

Tenders called vide this office letter No. PW-KD-E-Tender/2026-27-3076–79 dated 13-08-2026 and published in weekly Giriraj / daily leading various newspapers under R.O. No. 2671/2026-27 dated 14-08-2026 scheduled to be opened on 22-09-2026 for the work of Job No. 1. i.e **Construction of Level-III Trauma Centre Building at Kotkhal, District Shimla (HP). (SH: Civil Work, W.S & S.I, Rain water harvesting tank, Septic tank including Soak Pit, Site Development and Electrical installation etc.)** Tender I.D. 2026_PWD_143119_2 through e-tenders amendment in similar work done condition in the Bidding Documents i.e. general condition of contract (GCC) of Form No-6(NIT(condition No. 1.2.1 and General Rules and Directions Eligibility Criteria Sr. No. 26.2 (b) changed as under:-

Sr. No.	Name of Bid Documents	Clause / Conditions	Existing Conditions	May be read Now Amended / revised as under
1	General Condition of Contract(GCC)	**Form No.-6 (NIT), Condition No.1.2.1 and General Rules and Directions: Eligibility Criteria Sr. No. 26.2 (b):**	**Criteria of eligibility for contractors:** For work estimated to cost above Rs. 100 Lakh. **Minimum work done condition:-** Minimum one similar work done of amount no less than 40% (Forty percent) of the estimated cost (without Liquidated Damage or compensation) in last five years or minimum one Civil Engineering work amount not less than 80% (Eighty percent) of the estimated compensation) in last five years. The value of executed works hall be brought to current costing level by enhancing the actual value of work at simple rate of 5% per annum, calculated form the date of completion to the last date of receipt of application for tender.	Criteria of eligibility for contractor experience of having successful completed similar works during last seven years ending last day of **month previous to the one in which application are invited should be either of the following:-** Minimum three similar completed work each costing not less than 40% of the estimated cost put to tender. **Or** Minimum two similar completed works each costing not less than 60% of the estimated cost put to tender. **Or** Minimum one similar completed work costing not less than 80% of the estimated cost put to tender.

Executive Engineer,
(B&R) Division HPPWD,
Kotkhai
Ro.No 3442/2026-2027

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

1	**Name of work**	Repair and Renovation works of ladies, gents toilet at the holding area first floor, toilet at the station building including plumbing sanitary, filling and other allied civil & maintenance works at New Delhi Railway station in the section of SSE/W/NDLS under ADEN/NDLS.
2	**Approx cost of work**	Rs. 1,79,22,739.48 /- (Rupees One Crore Seventy Nine Lakh Twenty Two Thousand Seven Hundred Thirty Nine and Forty Eight Paise Only)
3	**Earnest Money to be deposited**	Rs 3,58,500.00/- (Rupees Three Lakh Fifty Eight Thousand Five Hundred Only)
4	**Cost of tender document**	Rs. 0.00/-
5	**Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender**	09.10.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.
6	**Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen**	**www.ireps.gov.in**
7	**Allocation**	04-410-32

• The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for participating in the e-tender system. • For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. • No manual offers are acceptable. • Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. **No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/44/2026-27/W-3 Dated :-16.09.2026 3221/2026**
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

CFM ASSET RECONSTRUCTION PRIVATE LIMITED
REGISTERED OFFICE: "Block no. A/1003, West Gate, Near YMCA Club, Sur No. 835/1+3, S. G. Highway, Makarba, Ahmedabad-380051 Gujarat"
CORPORATE OFFICE: 1st Floor, Wakefield House, Sprott Road, Ballard Estate, Mumbai-400038
EMAIL: info@cfmarc.in, sweta.rana@cfmarc.in, Anmol.mishra@cfmarc.in CONTACT: 022-40055282
thoughtful regeneration
CIN: U67100GJ2015PTC083994

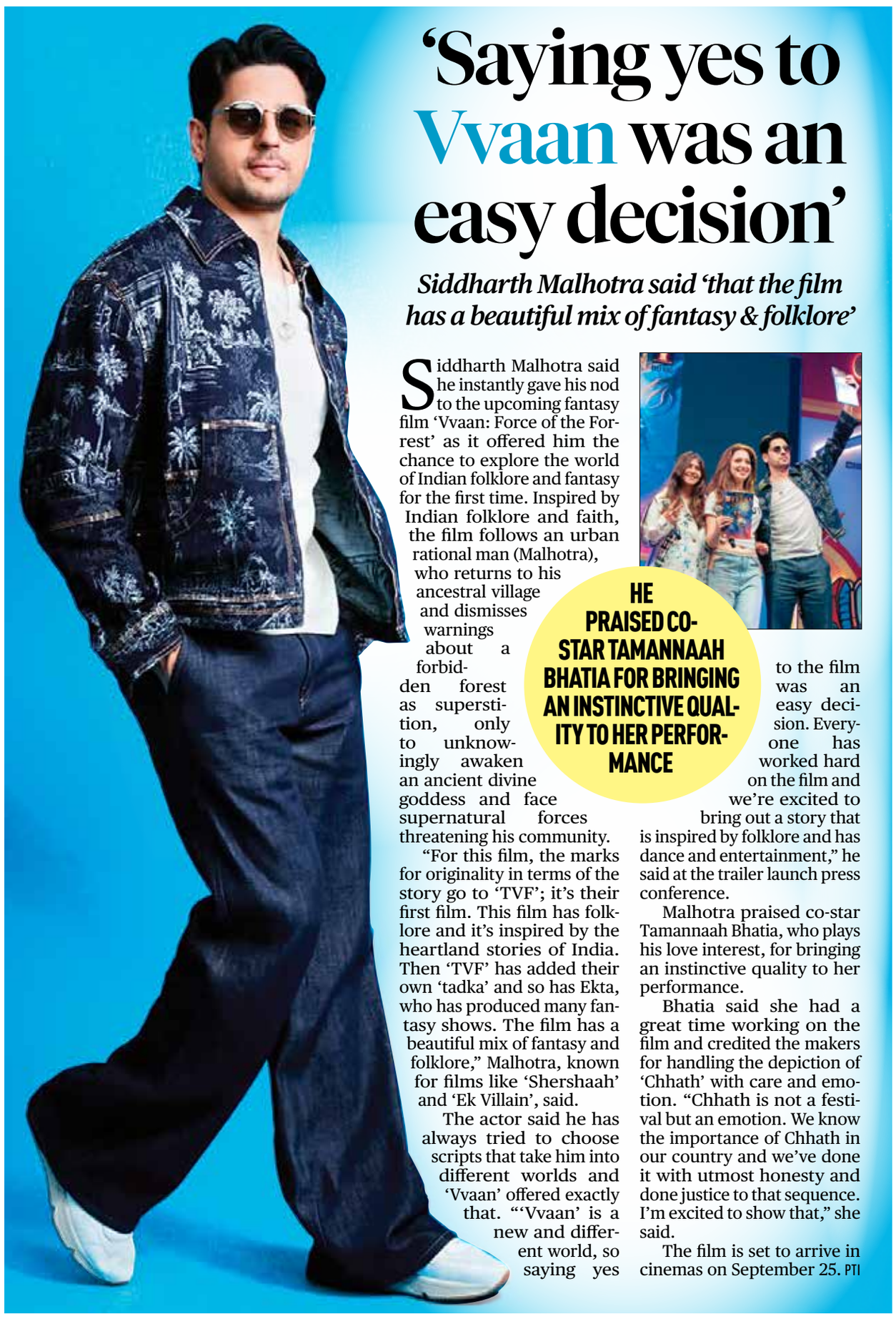
APPENDIX- IV-A
[See proviso to rule 8 (6)]
SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

E-auction Sale Notice for the sale of immovable assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to rule 8(6) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower/(s) and Guarantor/(s) that the below described immovable property (Secured Asset) mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of **CFM Asset Reconstruction Pvt. Ltd. (acting in its capacity as a Trustee of CFMARC Trust – 133** "The secured Creditor") will be sold **on "As is where is basis", "As is what is basis", "Whatever there is basis", and "No recourse basis" on 26.10.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.,** for recovery of **Rs.15,89,388/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh Eighty Nine Thousand Three Hundred Eighty Eight only)** pending towards Loan Account No. HHLDCP00131855, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 10.08.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w.e.f. 11.08.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor **from JAYPRAKASH NARAYAN JHA and SHALINI.**
The reserve price of the properties and the earnest money deposit is given below: -

DESCRIPTION OF SECURED PROPERTY:	Flat No. Le/E-501, Having Super Area 965 Square Feet On 5th Floor, Tower-E, In Luxuria Estate, Aditya World City, Off Nh-24, Sector-6, Ghaziabad-201010, Uttar Pradesh.
SECURED DEBT:	**Rs.15,89,388/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh Eighty Nine Thousand Three Hundred Eighty Eight only)** pending towards Loan Account No. HHLDCP00131855 as on 10.08.2026 together with further interest, other costs, and expenses thereon due and payable till the final payment.
RESERVE PRICE (RP):	**Rs.26,00,000/- (Rupees Twenty Six Lakh only)**
INSPECTION	Visit on request
TIME: DATE: PLACE: For E-AUCTION	**E-Auction/Bidding through website (www.auctionfocus.in) Date: 26.10.2026 Time: 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M**
LAST DATE AND TIME FOR BID SUBMISSION:	**On or before 3:00 PM on 26.10.2026**
EMD:	**Rs.2,60,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh Sixty Thousand only)**
CONTACT:	**0124-6910910, +91 7065451024**

Encumbrances if any: Not known to the secured creditor
For detailed terms & conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in Secured Creditors website i.e. https://www.cfmarc.in for detailed terms & conditions of e-auction/sale of respective properties and other details before submitting their bids for taking part in the e-auction. Bidders may also visit the website to www.auctionfocus.in or contact No.: 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: **auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com.**

Date: 16.09.2026 **Sd/- Authorised Officer**
Place: GHAZIABAD **CFM Asset Reconstruction Private Limited**
Acting as trustee of CFMARC Trust – 133



'Saying yes to Vvaan was an easy decision'

Siddharth Malhotra said 'that the film has a beautiful mix of fantasy & folklore'

Siddharth Malhotra said he instantly gave his nod to the upcoming fantasy film 'Vvaan: Force of the Forrest' as it offered him the chance to explore the world of Indian folklore and fantasy for the first time. Inspired by Indian folklore and faith, the film follows an urban rational man (Malhotra), who returns to his ancestral village and dismisses warnings about a forbidden forest as superstition, only to unknowingly awaken an ancient divine goddess and face supernatural forces threatening his community.

HE PRAISED CO-STAR TAMANNAAH BHATIA FOR BRINGING AN INSTINCTIVE QUALITY TO HER PERFORMANCE

"For this film, the marks for originality in terms of the story go to 'TVF'; it's their first film. This film has folklore and it's inspired by the heartland stories of India. Then 'TVF' has added their own 'tadka' and so has Ekta, who has produced many fantasy shows. The film has a beautiful mix of fantasy and folklore," Malhotra, known for films like 'Shershaah' and 'Ek Villain', said.

The actor said he has always tried to choose scripts that take him into different worlds and 'Vvaan' offered exactly that. "'Vvaan' is a new and different world, so saying yes to the film was an easy decision. Everyone has worked hard on the film and we're excited to bring out a story that is inspired by folklore and has dance and entertainment," he said at the trailer launch press conference.

Malhotra praised co-star Tamannaah Bhatia, who plays his love interest, for bringing an instinctive quality to her performance.

Bhatia said she had a great time working on the film and credited the makers for handling the depiction of 'Chhath' with care and emotion. "Chhath is not a festival but an emotion. We know the importance of Chhath in our country and we've done it with utmost honesty and done justice to that sequence. I'm excited to show that," she said.

The film is set to arrive in cinemas on September 25. PTI

'A film's budget doesn't govern its scope anymore'

Malayalam star Prithviraj Sukumaran said the success of spiritual film 'Hanuman Ansh', which has surprised many with its strong box office performance, is an example of how content can determine a movie's reach and prove that the scale of a film is no longer defined by its budget.

PRITHVIRAJ SUKUMARAN TALKED ABOUT THE SUCCESS OF 'HANUMAN ANSH'

"The budget of a film does not govern its scope anymore. It's just the content. If the budget of a film governed the scope, we wouldn't be talking about 'Hanuman Ansh' today," the actor told reporters at a promotional event for his upcoming movie 'Daayra'.

'Hanuman Ansh', a small-budget movie based on the life and teachings of spiritual leader Baba Neem Karoli, has emerged as one of the surprise hits of the year. PTI

Jessica Chastain boards 'THE RETRIEVALS'

She joins previously announced cast members Emilia Jones and Amy Ryan

Oscar-winner Jessica Chastain has joined the cast of 'The Retrievals', a new drama series from streaming service 'Netflix'. It's based on the 'New York Times' and 'Serial Productions' podcast of the same name by Susan Burton, reported 'Variety'.

Chastain, the star of films such as 'Zero Dark Thirty', 'The Martian', 'Molly's Game' and 'The Eyes of Tammy Faye', joins previously announced cast members Emilia Jones and Amy Ryan.

The actress will essay the role of Kaitlyn Langford, a former art historian who has 'spent the last decade stuck in an endless cycle of failed fertility treatments'. "When she learns she's also a victim of criminal drug diversion at the Yale Fertility Centre, she faces a devastating personal reckoning and becomes a key plaintiff in this historic lawsuit against Yale," read the official logline.

Chastain 'was the writing team's 'exemplar' while crafting the role of Kaitlyn', said showrunner, writer and executive producer Molly Smith Metzler. PTI

51ST TORONTO INTERNATIONAL FILM FESTIVAL

'Phoolan' earns a grand standing ovation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Amazon Original's movie 'Phoolan', directed and written by acclaimed filmmaker Richie Mehta, received a standing ovation from a packed audience of over 2,000 at its world premiere at the 51st Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF). Screened as part of the festival's coveted 'Special Presentation' section, the film left audiences deeply moved and drew unanimous praise from critics and cinephiles alike at the iconic Princess of Wales Theatre, one of Toronto's most celebrated cultural landmarks.

'Phoolan' is an action drama that chronicles an extraordinary and tumultuous moment in Phoolan Devi's life during a 48-hour siege. Based on Phoolan Devi's autobiography, 'I, Phoolan Devi: The Autobiography of India's Bandit Queen' published by 'Editions Robert Laffont', the film is a visceral account of a young woman who defied every convention imposed upon her and seized her own destiny in a world determined to deny her one.

IT'S AN ACTION DRAMA THAT CHRONICLES AN EXTRAORDINARY AND TUMULTUOUS MOMENT IN PHOOLAN DEVI'S LIFE DURING A 48-HOUR SIEGE

Speaking about the world premiere, writer-director and producer Richie Mehta said, "Phoolan Devi's story demands to be told with honesty and without compromise. I was drawn to a very specific chapter of Phoolan's life, the formative years before the world knew her name, contrasted with the period when she was a misunderstood legend. It felt essential to me to strip away the mythology and reveal the human underneath. The themes at the heart of her story - resilience in the face of adversity, the search for dignity and the courage to claim one's own voice - are timeless."

BEYOND THE UNIFORM

LOOKING AT POLICING AS A SERVICE DELIVERY ORGANISATION

The book was formally launched on September 16, 2026, at Seminar Halls I, II & III, Kamaladevi Complex, India International Centre

OUR CORRESPONDENT

You are the pioneers in the Indian Service and the future of the Service will depend much upon the foundations and traditions that will be laid down by you, by your character and abilities and by your spirit of service."
– Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, 'The Bombay Chronicle', April 21, 1947

With a tribute to Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's saying, 'Niyogi Books' proudly announces the arrival of their latest publication, 'Beyond the Uniform - Duty, Discretion and Public Trust: Citizen-Friendly and Responsive Policing' by retired Indian Police Service officer of the Arunachal, Goa, Mizoram and Union Territory (AGMUT) cadre, O P Mishra. Published under the imprint 'Paper Missile', the book looks at policing as a service delivery organisation and examines areas where there is a trust deficit between the citizen and the police and suggests measures to bridge the gap between the two.

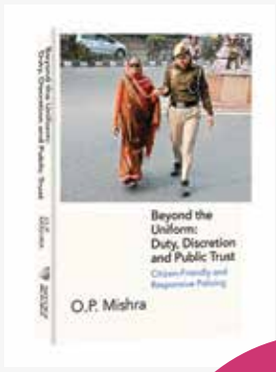
The book was formally launched on September 16, 2026, at Seminar Halls I, II & III, Kamaladevi Complex, India International Centre, New Delhi, at 6 pm. Chief Guest Chief Justice of India Justice Surya Kant launched the book in the presence of Guests of Honour, Neeraj Kumar IPS (Retd.), former Commissioner of Police, New Delhi and Sanjaya Baru, former Media Advisor to the Prime Minister.

Sanjaya Baru observed that with the growing influence of social media, the police have increasingly come under public scrutiny, making controversies involving the force more visible than ever before. He noted that, at this crucial juncture, a book examining policing is especially relevant and deserves wider attention for its potential to help rebuild public trust in the police. He also highlighted the need for greater administrative reforms and drew attention to India's low police-to-population ratio, which continues to affect citizens' access to police services.

Neeraj Kumar emphasised that the police must consistently meet public expectations at every point of interaction, ensuring that citizens feel respected and their experiences inspire confidence in the institution. He noted that effective police leadership lies in identifying these points of public contact and strengthening professionalism at every supervisory level. He further highlighted the importance of carefully examining charge sheets and other legal documents, while appreciating the book for offering practical solutions drawn from O P Mishra's own experience in policing.

Delivering the keynote address, CJI Justice Surya Kant remarked that 'Beyond the Uniform' brings together the themes of duty, discretion, law, leadership and police reform, placing public trust at the heart of the conversation. He observed that the responsibilities of the police begin long before a crisis arises, requiring constant preparedness and an institutional framework capable of responding effectively whenever citizens need assistance. Stressing the importance of responsible discretion in the exercise of police powers, he noted that effective first-level supervision remains fundamental to the delivery of justice.

When asked to comment on his book, O P Mishra said, "In democracy, various organs of the government are actually service providers. These organisations facilitate the delivery of various kinds of services to citizens as mandated by the Indian Constitution. The overall performance and evaluation of these organisations is based on the quality of services delivered to the citizens. The police are an important and critical service provider that delivers exclusive services to citizens in day-to-day policing. Despite serving on the street 24/7, the police don't enjoy the trust and confidence they deserve from the common man. This has always troubled me in my 36-year policing career. The book looks at this broader question of the trust deficit between police and the public. It identifies concrete areas of day-to-day operational policing processes where this deficit exists and suggests measures to bridge the gap between the police and the public."



WRITTEN BY O.P. MISHRA, IT'S AN EXAMINATION OF INDIAN POLICING - ITS COLONIAL INHERITANCES, STRUCTURAL DISTORTIONS AND THE NEED FOR REFORM

'Beyond the Uniform' is an examination of Indian policing - its colonial inheritances, structural distortions and the need for reform. Drawing upon constitutional principles, key interventions of the Supreme Court of India and over three decades of service, author O P Mishra identifies systemic gaps that hinder humane service delivery and accountability and erode public faith in the system: delays in registering FIRs, unnecessary arrests, custodial violence, corruption at the thana level and political interference in postings and investigations.

Yet this book isn't merely a critique. It is also a blueprint for change. By looking at recent legal reforms such as the 'Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita', the growing role of forensic science and technology-driven investigations, the book argues for a policing culture grounded in professionalism, transparency and empathy.